

HIRE

**HOW TO ATTRACT, HIRE, AND MANAGE THE
BEST REMOTE TALENT IN THE WORLD**

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Advance Reader Copy
Not for Sale

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Dedication

For Greg Smith

Who taught me to see people as miracles.

Note from the Author

A real human wrote this book. Maybe that doesn't matter anymore—but I feel like it does. While I use AI to ideate, brainstorm, and even spotcheck my formatting, the words you read here are my own. I actually sat down and pecked out the entirety of this book—all by my lonesome—then with some help from a few friendly readers and a professional editor.

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INTRODUCTION

I didn't want to write this book.

I wanted to write a book on delegation, which is one of the topics I'm most passionate about—it's one of the most important skills an entrepreneur can learn.

But there's a catch with delegation—a critical prerequisite most people overlook:

It only works if you have someone effective to delegate to.

In other words, your delegation can only be as good as the “who” that you're delegating to.

That's what people struggle with most when they're learning to delegate. It's not that they're bad at delegating—it's that they're delegating to the wrong people.

Which leads to the obvious question: *How do you find the right people?*

Lucky for you, I spent twenty years of my life answering that question and then building a step-by-step framework to make it consistent, predictable, and pain free.

I call it the Pareto Talent Framework, and I'm going to give it to you in its entirety in this book. And—if you don't mind me saying—it's the greatest framework for hiring that exists.

Not because I'm better or smarter than anyone else. I just happened to spend two decades obsessing over this one problem and shamelessly borrowing from dozens of really smart people along the way.

Think of this as a compilation of the world's best practices, battle tested across multiple entrepreneurial environments over the course of twenty years.

The result is a step-by-step process with templates and easy-to-follow guides to help you hire the best talent you've ever seen in your entrepreneurial life.

If you want to hire peak performers, people who do more than they're asked and actually feel like they're helping you to share the load, then The Pareto Talent Framework is your answer.

PS – I want to make **YOU** my next success story. If you use my method to land a new hire:

- Share your story on social
- Tag me, @KasimAslam

I'll hook you up with a **FREE 5-day exclusive training** that'll turn your new hire into a battleready remote rockstar!

Pro Tip: The Pareto Talent Framework works for any business, in any market, for any role you can imagine. In twenty years, I've only found one exception: Outbound Sales. Why? My theory is that great outbound salespeople don't need to look for jobs—they've got the skills to kick down doors and land their dream role without your help.

WHAT IS “PARETO TALENT?”

The Pareto Principle, also known as the 80/20 rule, states that 80 percent of outcomes come from 20 percent of causes.

The distribution varies but the core idea is that in every organic ecosystem, there's an unequal relationship between inputs and outputs.

This might be one of the most important concepts to understand in business and in life.

A few examples:

- 80 percent of a company's revenue comes from 20 percent of its clients.
- 80 percent of the world's honey comes from 20 percent of bees.
- 80 percent of all crimes are committed by 20 percent of criminals.
- 80 percent of an e-commerce business's sales come from 20 percent of its products.
- 80 percent of the work is done by 20 percent of the employees.

That last one should sting a little.

Here's where things get really interesting: The Pareto Principle is *fractal*, meaning the 80/20 distribution pattern repeats at every scale of analysis.

For example, 20 percent of your efforts typically produce 80 percent of your results. But it goes deeper—within that top 20 percent, another 20 percent (just 4 percent of your total effort) can drive 64 percent of your overall results.

To put that in real-world terms: if you have 1,000 employees, 200 of them are driving 80 percent of your company's total output. Within that group, 40 are responsible for 80 percent of *that* output. And just 8 people?

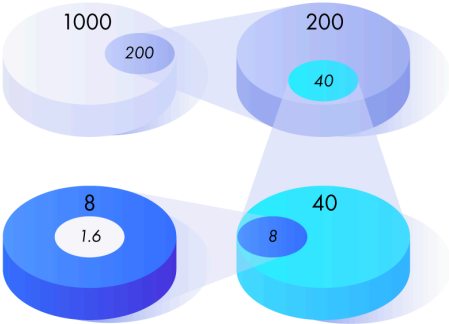
They’re producing the lion’s share of that output—the true top-tier performers.

The table below shows what that looks like in real numbers, with the left column representing the number of people and the right column representing the percentage of total output they’re responsible for:

People	Ownership percent of the total output
1000	100 percent
200	80 percent
40	64 percent
8	51.2 percent
1.6	40.69 percent

What this tells us is that one person is effectively responsible for about 25 percent of the organization’s total output.

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1000	100 percent
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1.6	40.69 percent



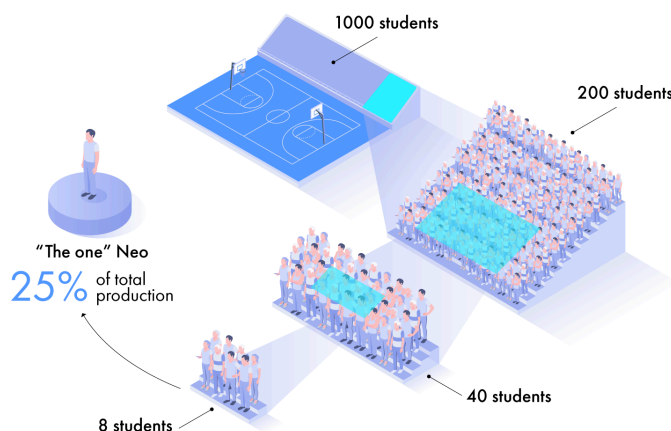
Just for fun, let’s picture this...

The average high school gymnasium holds about 1,000 people. So, imagine your old high school gym full of these make-believe employees.

Take 992 of them and put them on one side of the gym. That's where 49 percent of your output comes from.

On the other side of the gym sit your eight superstars who are responsible for 51 percent of your output.

And leading the pack is “the one”—*Neo*. The superstar pulling half the weight of the top eight, and 25 percent of the 1,000.



That should melt your brain just a little bit.

This is why even people who think they know “the 80/20 rule” still fail to understand the staggering magnitude of its impact, especially when it comes to employee productivity.

When you find a true peak performer, their impact isn't just a little better—it's *exponentially* better.

I call these people *Pareto Talent*—elite contributors who consistently deliver 10x, 20x, even 100x the results of their peers.

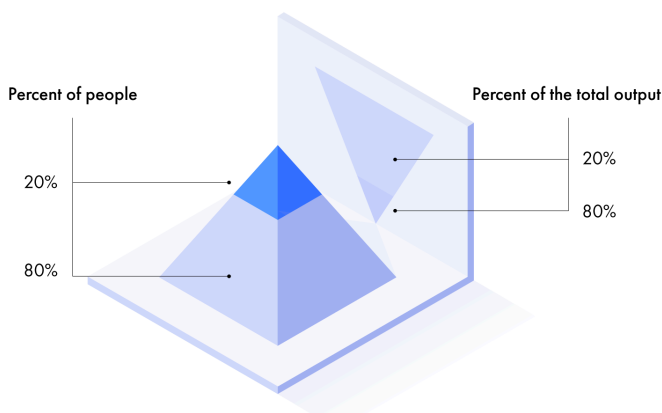
Here's the absolutely insane part: instead of harnessing that potential, most organizations actually fight *against* the Pareto Principle when it comes to their people.

You'll hear phrases like "key man risk," where excessive reliance on one person is seen as a liability rather than an asset.

So, what do companies do? They try to "mitigate the risk." Meaning, they end up stifling the talent that drives the greatest success.

Imagine a business as a hierarchical structure, where the most valuable resources exist at the top. This hierarchy looks like a pyramid. The higher you go, the more powerful the people and the greater their output.

The truth is, the top 20 percent of the pyramid produces the majority of that business's output. And within that group, the top 20 percent produces 80 percent of *that* output—and so on.



So how do most businesses contend with this natural and inescapable law?

They try to flatten the pyramid.

They enforce averages, treat employees as interchangeable, and build systems that ignore individual performance.

It's wildly self-defeating—if only they could see what they're doing.

They're not mitigating risk; they're sacrificing potential. All so their consultants, advisors, and middle managers can avoid seeing existential threats on a spreadsheet.

When I sold my last company, I had 80 employees managing paid ad campaigns for 200 clients.

One person—John Moran—was responsible for nearly 40 percent of our revenue. (You may know of him. Today, he's arguably the greatest Google Ads mind on the planet.)

For most organizations, this is an untenable risk. They wouldn't dare let one employee hold so much influence.

The problem with this mindset is that it treats people like commodities—something we'll dig into more later.

When you create quotas and define roles based on uniform outputs, you turn individuals into automatons—interchangeable parts expected to produce predictable results, like cows or assembly line robots.

And what do you do with a commodity? You easily swap it out for another one.

So, the Ivy League business consultant comes in and says, "Just take all of the clients that make up nearly 40 percent of your revenue and spread them across a few of your other equally 'viable' commodities."

Problem solved. Thank you, Harvard Business School.

But, in the real world, it doesn't work that way. In the real world, if you lose John, you lose the vast majority of that revenue.

You're left with a sea of average employees (literally) producing average results, which leads to—*you guessed it*—an average business.

The key isn't mitigating Pareto risks. The key is *harnessing* them—gamifying the Pareto Principle so you can benefit from it. And when you're able to do so, the upside is staggering.

Think back to our pyramid. What happens when you build the base of your pyramid with the same level of talent other businesses have at the top?

Answer: massive leverage.

If you've had the privilege of working with Pareto Talent, you know exactly what I'm talking about.

If you haven't—just wait. It's such a powerful experience when you work with people who can move mountains and run through walls. As it turns out, it's the single most powerful shift you'll experience in your business.

Luckily, you won't have to wait long. Using the Pareto Talent Framework laid out in this book, you're already on the path to seeing this for yourself.

I've used it myself to build a small empire.

Which leads me to...

THE PROOF IS IN THE PUDDING

A lot of people have a lot of opinions. And let's be honest—any idiot can write a book these days.

So, why should you spend your time with me and mine?

The first question I like to ask myself whenever I'm trying to evaluate a so-called "expert" is: *What are their proven, demonstrable outcomes—especially in the area they claim expertise?*

I'm a self-made decamillionaire—in real money, not inflated valuations, sketchy projections, or imaginary assets. I've built six (and counting) seven- and eight-figure businesses, all running at solid 20 percent to 40 percent margins. I've had two successful exits, the latest being an eight-figure deal with a SoftBank-backed MarTech company.

I'm not saying any of this to brag or to posture. I'm saying this so you know what my advice is actually worth.

Gross revenue is a vanity metric. You can't eat likes, followers, or subscribers. And anyone can rent a Ferrari on Turo or a beach house on AirBnB, shoot a bunch of TikTok videos, and spout off "sounds-good" business platitudes.

Profit doesn't lie. Money is how we keep score. I played the game. I won the game. And you deserve to know what my playbook is worth in real dollars and cents.

That works both ways. I'm giving you deca-million dollar knowledge—because that's what I've built. If we're measuring impact by wealth, then Alex Hormozi's advice might be worth ten times mine. And Ray Dalio's? Roughly 140 times his—assuming we're talking about topics tied to their actual wealth-building expertise.

We should all make it a habit to question any expert, thought leader, or self-proclaimed guru who doesn't publish their real-world results. Here are mine:

What are my outcomes as it pertains to hiring?

- I've employed hundreds of people across the globe.
- My longest-tenured employee is approaching a decade.
- Three of my former employees have become business partners in various ventures.
- My largest business, Solutions 8, sold with 80 staff members and a near perfect 4.8-star Glassdoor.com rating (from 39 reviews).
- Every success I've had in business has come down to my ability to find Pareto Talent.

I believe that you can dominate any business, in any industry, without any specialized knowledge—as long as you have the right people.

Here's my proof—straight from real experience:

SOLUTIONS 8

I built the top-ranked Google Ads agency in the world—Solutions 8.

For years, we held the number one organic position globally for the search term “Google Ads agency.” Even as late as October 2022 (when I exited), we maintained that top spot. As I write this, we're still the first agency listed in organic search results.

While no governing body officially tracks agency size or growth, my M&A advisor believed we were the largest dedicated Google Ads agency at the time of our sale—managing 200 clients, 80 employees, and \$100,000,000 in ad spend.

Ready for the best part?

I have never run a Google Ads campaign in my life.

Instead, I built and scaled the agency by finding and cultivating the best Google Ads talent in the world.

Fun fact: When I sold Solutions 8, we had consistently achieved near 40 percent margins for over two years. According to HubSpot's benchmark statistics, the average digital marketing agency considers 15 percent a high water mark.

This efficiency came from two key factors:

1. Hiring world-class talent.
2. Leveraging financial arbitrage by hiring internationally.

That was a really gobbly-goop way of saying: You save a ton of money by hiring folks from “emerging nations” (since we’re apparently not allowed to say “third world countries” anymore).

You also get to change lives in the process—which is a pretty great side benefit, if you’re into that sort of thing.

GEOFLIP

In similar fashion, I built the highest-performing real estate investor lead generation business in the U.S.

For seven years, we outperformed every major competitor in every major market by an average of four to one (according to *InvestorFuse*, one of the largest CRMs for real estate investors at the time).

When I built GeoFlip, I had zero experience as a real estate investor or as a lead generator. This business was built by finding the best and most talented people in both areas.

I sold this business to my partner in 2019—my first successful business exit.

NIDO MARKETING

I have a passion for Montessori education and believe every child deserves the opportunity to attend a Montessori school. To help further their reach, I started a marketing agency specializing in Montessori schools.

Today, Nido Marketing is the largest and most successful agency in the space of Montessori education. It also owns and operates one of the largest global communities for Montessori Administrators, Montessori Thrive.

And yet—I have no Montessori education (or *any* formal education, for that matter). Instead, I found passionate, brilliant Montessorians to help me build and run the agency.

I repeat, in each of these businesses, I had absolutely no pre-existing knowledge or skill set in the industry. I simply focused on finding the best people for the job—and then got the hell out of their way.

THE PARETO TALENT FRAMEWORK

Before we dive in, go grab The Pareto Talent Framework templates at TheHireBook.com/Free. I'll reference them throughout the book, and trust me—you'll want them.

GRAB THE **PARETO TALENT FRAMEWORK**

Everything you need to stop guessing and start hiring like a pro, **for FREE**:

- ✓ Plug-and-play **hiring templates & email scripts**
- ✓ Legally-reviewed **contractor agreement**
- ✓ Curated **global job board** with top talent
- ✓ Pareto Talent **SOPs and delegation documents**
- ✓ Shareable **PDF copy** of this entire book



Download it all now:
TheHireBook.com/Free

Success story? Tag Kasim on social to get your new hire access to our **5-day training for FREE!**

Now, here's what the Pareto Talent Framework looks like, step by step:

1. Clarify Your Core Principles
2. Create a Job Posting
3. Plan Your Distribution Strategy
4. Filter the Stack
5. Run the Tryouts
6. Conduct the Interviews
7. Onboard for Success (The First 90 Days)

I know—this probably looks backwards compared to the hiring process you're used to.

That's by design. This method is intentionally different, and as you'll see throughout the book, it's built to save you a significant amount of time *and* surface the highest-quality candidates you've ever seen.

Not only does it help you find the right people—it filters out the wrong ones long before they ever reach an interview (more time saved—you're welcome).

I didn't invent this from scratch. The Pareto Talent Framework is an amalgamation of hiring strategies I've tested, refined, and borrowed over decades.

(In other words, if hiring frameworks were literary characters, mine would be Frankenstein's monster.)

Which means you should feel completely comfortable chopping it up. Add, edit, and adjust it to fit your business and the specific role you're hiring for. Nothing is sacred.

Will every part of this framework feel easy? No. The best things rarely are.

But I promise you this: if you follow the process, if you do the work, you will see results.

You will learn exactly how to identify, attract, and retain the kind of game-changing talent that will transform your business.

This system has been battle-tested across multiple industries, in multiple markets, over multiple decades. And I'm giving it to you in its entirety—no fluff, no filler, just what works.

Let's get started.

STEP 1

CLARIFY YOUR CORE PRINCIPLES

Now, let's tackle the second question I ask when deciding whether to listen to someone's expertise: *Am I aligned with their core principles?*

My advice is only as helpful as how closely our guiding principles align. If we're not aligned here, you won't be able to use the Pareto Talent Framework at all (you'll see why soon). So before we go any further, let's make sure we're speaking the same language.

To truly leverage the Pareto Talent Framework, you must believe:

- ✓ Every person is a miracle with boundless capabilities just waiting to be unlocked.
- ✓ The goal is finding people smarter and more capable than you—even in the areas where you excel.
- ✓ Location doesn't matter (aside from logistical exceptions).
- ✓ Education and experience are secondary to tenacity and will.
- ✓ The employer-employee relationship should be a big win-win.
- ✓ AI doesn't replace people—it amplifies the right ones.

Because these beliefs are so foundational, let's take a moment to unpack each one.

1.1 - PEOPLE ARE MIRACLES, NOT COMMODITIES

People are *not* a commodity. That statement might seem obvious on its own, but add context, and suddenly, it's not so clear.

For an example, look no further than every single job board on the planet:

- Wanted: Graphic Designer.
- We're looking for a Software Engineer.
- Now hiring Traveling Nurses!

Job postings read like classified ads for machinery, reducing people to roles rather than recognizing them as unique individuals with distinct skills, experiences, and values.

Categorization is necessary for simplicity, but we often take it too far—crossing into territory that borders on dehumanizing.

In my experience, much of conventional business wisdom, advice, and training treats people as commodities.

Investopedia defines *commodity* as “a basic good used in commerce that is interchangeable with other goods of the same type.”

And that's the thing: People are neither basic nor interchangeable. Obviously.

Yet, that's exactly how they're treated in nearly every business conversation. We've been trained to see people as cogs in the machine.

The classic formula for building a scalable business looks something like this:

1. Build a system.
2. Put an easy-to-find, cookie-cutter human in place to execute the system.
3. Profit.

But people aren't cookie-cutter. And when you treat them that way, you lose access to almost everything that makes them valuable.

People are a miracle. (And, yes, I do mean that literally.)

Oxford Dictionary defines a *miracle* as “a surprising and welcome event that is not explicable by natural or scientific laws and is therefore considered to be the work of a divine agency.”

You don't have to believe in God to appreciate the sheer improbability of human existence. (If anything, atheists should be more in awe than anyone.)

We're a self-propagating species of super-brilliant, super-apes whose capabilities continue to expand beyond anyone's imagination.

Uh, WOW.

Everything amazing that has ever been accomplished—or ever will be—has been accomplished by people or something people built.

And, get this: Those same people are available and accessible to you.

That's the global labor pool.

Einstein worked as a patent clerk.

Steve Jobs was an Atari technician.

J.K. Rowling was a secretary.

Oprah worked at a grocery store.

Disney was a train conductor.

Carnegie worked at a cotton factory.

Van Gogh was a teacher.

Madonna worked at Dunkin' Donuts.

Howard Schultz was a bartender.

Gandhi was a lawyer (ew).

The lesson here isn't that these outstanding successes had humble beginnings.

The real lesson is that every single grocery store clerk, secretary, bartender, and yes—*even lawyer*—has the potential to achieve extraordinary, world-changing things.

All they need is drive and, more importantly, opportunity.

That's where you come in.

You can be that opportunity—or at least a stepping stone that gets them there.

Everyone needs to work. And thankfully, most people aren't entrepreneurs. That means they need to work for people like you and me.

You're not looking for a cog in the machine.

You're looking for a miracle.

You need someone who can make an impact, do more than is asked, be creative, be thoughtful, be proactive, and unleash their genius.

And if you're not looking for that—you should be!

That may be your biggest problem: you haven't set your sights high enough.

You're going to find what you look for. If you're looking for someone who can “just do the job” or “just follow the system,” that's all you're going to find.

But there's so much more out there. I've seen it *hundreds* of times.

And I don't care how small you think the role you're hiring for is—you can find an absolute miracle of a human who will treat it like the greatest opportunity they've ever had.

Once you know how to find Pareto Talent, it becomes addictive. It's so much fun to find amazing talent and unleash them on your problems. It's the most fun you'll ever have in business.

But before you can start, *you have to change the way you think about people.*

They're not cogs in the machine.

They're not basic commodities.

They are literal, awe-inspiring miracles.

And you and I? We should count ourselves lucky to have the opportunity to be employers.

It's a sacred trust, an honor, and a privilege.

Heaven forgive us should we ever lose sight of that.

1.2 - THE GOAL IS TO HIRE PEOPLE WHO ARE SMARTER AND MORE CAPABLE THAN YOU

Have you ever caught yourself thinking or saying things like...

- *"If you want it done right, you have to do it yourself."*
- *"No one cares as much as I do."*
- *"You can't rely on anyone these days."*
- *"Good help is hard to come by."*
- *"The work ethic isn't what it used to be."*
- *"It's impossible to find someone who's willing to go the extra mile."*

I could go on. I won't. You get the point.

Again, we've got to flip this thinking on its head.

I want to be the dumbest, least capable, least effective person in any of my organizations. At least as it pertains to any specific role.

Imagine the opposite.

Seriously! Let's run with this for a second.

Picture the average business owner—whoever that might be for you. They're hard at work, surrounded by their employees, keeping the business running.

Now, think about everything that happens inside their company: Operations, finance, HR, marketing, sales, customer service, legal compliance, IT, product development, fulfillment, supply chain, strategic planning, and on and on and on.

Even the simplest businesses require an overwhelming amount of skills and knowledge to function.

Now, imagine this business owner is the best person at literally everything their business does.

The best at marketing. The best at customer service. The best at sales, operations, strategy—*everything*.

What do you see?

Are you picturing a superhuman dynamo whose capabilities know no bounds?

Or do you see someone who's frazzled, exhausted, and overwhelmed—surrounded by a team of duds waiting around for direction?

Exactly.

Don't let that be you.

To avoid that fate, you have to shift your expectations.

Remember, you're going to find what you're looking for.

So let's make sure you're looking for the best, most capable person for the job.

Assume there's someone out there who could absolutely blow you out of the water. Expect it. Believe it. Make it an unquestionable truth in your mind.

Here's what's really interesting about this new paradigm:

Most entrepreneurs don't struggle to believe that there are smarter, more capable people out there.

They struggle with what that means *for them*.

Instead of being excited by it, they're scared. Intimidated.

Sometimes, this fear is conscious. Other times, it's beneath the surface. Either way, it's wholly justified.

Hiring someone who outpaces you can be daunting.

How do you train and manage someone who's better than you?

What if they realize you actually need them? (*Gasp!*) Will they hold you hostage?

Or, even worse, will they take what you teach them and just go do it on their own?

In light of these fears, it's incredibly common for entrepreneurs to surround themselves with people they may feel are a little more... shall we say, "manageable?"

The problem is—"manageable" cuts both ways.

"Manageable" people need to actually be managed.

Meaning, you end up surrounding yourself with people who need to be led at every turn.

These, my friends, are *not* peak performers.

Definitely not Pareto Talent.

So even if it means stepping outside your comfort zone, you have to commit to hiring people who can outpace you—whatever the role may be.

1.3 - LOCATION DOESN'T MATTER (LOGISTICAL EXCEPTIONS ASIDE)

This used to be an uphill battle of a conversation. Then COVID-19 happened and made most of my points for me.

Overnight, the entire world discovered that most work can be done remotely.

Things we never dreamed of doing virtually suddenly became normal—from doctors appointments and legal depositions to interior design consultations. Even yoga classes!

Looking back, I think we all felt a little silly having gone out of our way to do so many of these things in person for so long.

Best of all, when the coast was declared clear, no one wanted to go back to the old ways.

No matter how you feel about remote work, it's now the gold standard for attracting top talent.

I've been a proponent of virtual work since 2014.

At the time, I owned a marketing agency with a business partner. When our partnership ended, I had to figure out how to run the company alone.

We had a dozen employees, all working out of a small office in Scottsdale, Arizona.

After buying out my partner, I threw a Hail Mary and asked the entire team to work from home.

Maybe I was a visionary genius who saw the virtual horizon before the rest of the world. Or maybe I was just a desperate, in-over-his-head entrepreneur trying to cut costs after an expensive buyout.

I'll let you decide.

Either way, it worked.

I eliminated my biggest operating expense and—much more importantly—my business actually became way, way easier to run.

And guess what? The benefits didn't end there.

As the company grew, I realized that I was no longer limited to a thirty-mile hiring radius. The entire global talent pool was suddenly wide open to me.

And, because I had an already-proven model with established pricing and value anchors, my profitability skyrocketed as I began hiring international talent at lower labor costs.

Best of all, I became the bell of the employment ball. All of the “real” talent in the States wanted to work for huge companies with big names or VC-backed startups with stock options. Small businesses like mine couldn't compete.

But overseas, it was a different story.

Highly skilled professionals in emerging nations looked at me the same way domestic workers looked at unicorn startups. My company was a dream opportunity—one they were willing and excited to work for.

For my stateside readers: I get it. You can scream until your forehead vein pops about “stealing ‘Merican jobs,” but that won’t change the practical reality of hiring as a small business in this country.

Here’s the truth:

It’s never been easier to be an entrepreneur or freelancer in the U.S. of A. (God bless it.) That’s great for individuals, but it puts employers at an incredible disadvantage because we simply cannot compete with all the benefits of being your own boss.

For the folks who do want a traditional job, small businesses can’t even come close to matching the benefits large employers are able to offer due to their bulk-buy capabilities.

That leaves us picking from the leftovers (and there’s a reason they’re left over).

Now, compare that to what happens when I start looking internationally. Talent in emerging nations is just as skilled as—*if not more skilled than*—talent in the U.S. (*Le gasp!*)

There are extraordinarily brilliant and hardworking people in every country in the world. However, the vast majority of countries don’t have the same employment opportunities we often take for granted.

That creates a supply-and-demand “problem” that works in your favor. The key is being willing to hire international talent for *real* work.

Most businesses are only willing to go international for their grunt work—cold calling, data entry, list scraping, outreach, inbox spamming, and so on.

And, believe it or not, they have a horrible experience trying to get people to do their garbage work. Surprise, surprise.

(Tell me—how excited would *you* be to kick ass at a soul-sucking data entry job?)

Meanwhile, I've found triple-PhD-level talent all over the world—people dying for an opportunity to prove themselves.

These are professionals who could have been C-Level executives at Fortune 100 companies had they not lost the geographic lottery. Instead, they're stuck working jobs far beneath their capabilities—because no one is willing to give them a shot.

Until now. *Now*, you can be that someone.

And, at the risk of soapboxing, the impact you can make in these peoples' lives is immeasurable. You might be the single best employment opportunity they've ever had.

Talk about a win-win.

Is it all sunshine and rainbows?

No, of course not.

You'll have to figure out cultural and language barriers, time zones, international holidays, and a host of other small micro-frictions that could drive you crazy if you let them. (For some insights on tackling these challenges, check out the Bonus Chapter at the end of the book.)

But if you're willing to muscle through it, you'll find yourself with an arsenal of talent that even the biggest and most well-equipped companies struggle to tap into because they refuse to broaden their horizons.

The last thing I'll say is in response to the Instagram crusaders who will show up in the comments screaming about "exploitation."

First, paying someone many multiples of what they could make locally is not exploitation.

Secondly, yes—the world isn't fair. It's a tragedy that some people have limited opportunities just because of arbitrarily-drawn, invisible lines and political systems outside of their control.

Providing employment opportunities to these people isn't exploitation.

It's access.

It's the chance for them to earn more, contribute more, and improve their lives—in a way that wouldn't have been possible without you.

So let's freaking go.

1.4 - TENACITY AND WILL MATTER MORE THAN CREDENTIALS

A favorite mantra of mine when it comes to hiring:

Hire for will, train for skill.

I have no idea what role you're hiring for. Even so, I can say with the confidence of a petulant child—there's no degree that will fully qualify someone for the job.

I don't care if you're trying to hire a graphic designer and you find someone with a PhD in graphic design from Harvard—that degree doesn't guarantee they'll be the best fit.

If anything, that kind of degree can also come with an enormous sense of entitlement, a resistance to feedback, and outrageous salary demands—making that person harder to manage, not easier.

Education and experience mean absolutely nothing to me until I see how someone actually works.

I'm not saying to discard educational prerequisites entirely. They can be icing on the cake if everything else checks out. But, just like icing, they don't factor into the recipe until we have a solid cake.

Using the Pareto Talent Framework, you'll be able to naturally test for talent and capabilities first—then use that insight to see where improvement is possible and how coachable the candidate is.

Some of my absolute best hires have been people with raw, unrefined talent—because they have the potential to grow and adapt in ways that perfectly align with what the business needs.

The truth is, trying to find employees who are one hundred percent “battle-ready” puts you at a disadvantage because you end up inheriting bad training, bad habits, and bad thinking from their previous employers.

All of that to say, if you require new hires to have specific degrees or years of experience, you're shrinking your talent pool and putting yourself at a huge disadvantage.

1.5 - SUCCESS IS SHARED—MAKE IT A WIN-WIN

Pareto Talent isn't just “better” than the average employee. They're an entirely different species.

If you think “normal” employees feel like lemmings and automatons now, just wait until you've worked with Pareto Talent.

You'll quickly realize you've been settling—hiring people who can barely meet expectations and push back as often as they contribute.

But when you start cultivating Pareto Talent, it's like tapping into a secret pool of nuclear-powered superheroes who can take on almost anything.

Imagine going to war with those powerhouses—while everyone else is staffing their armies with field mice, skunks, and sloths.

And you?

You've got lions, tigers, and bears—oh my!

It'll feel unfair. That's because it is. Talk about a win for you.

However, if you want this massively unfair advantage, you have to remember something:

Winners want to win. If you want to hire winners, give them an opportunity that looks and feels like a win. In other words, if you want to recruit these superheroes, be the type of place they'd want to work.

I call these "Success Pillars." While they vary by company, role, and individual, these five pillars are core motivators for most employees:

1. Compensation
2. Community
3. Purpose
4. Freedom
5. Growth

Let's break them down.

1. COMPENSATION: PAY MORE BECAUSE IT PAYS OFF

There's nothing more expensive than a cheap employee.

Sure, you might save money upfront by paying less—but in the long run, cheap hires cost you more in turnover, low performance, constant oversight, and missed opportunities.

Remember how we started this section: People aren't commodities. However, the business world still teaches us to pay them as though they are.

We're constantly told to try to find bargain-bin basement employees, pay as little as possible, and squeeze everything we can out of them.

Here's what people who hire that way don't understand:

When you hire Pareto Talent, the exchange is overwhelmingly in your favor.

You could pay two, three, or even five times the industry average—but you won't just get an equal increase in output on the other end.

You'll get 10x, 20x, 30x, sometimes even 100x the output. That's the Pareto effect in action.

If you've experienced this firsthand, you know how impossible it is to explain to someone who hasn't.

And one of the biggest reasons paying more works? You take money worries off the table.

How productive can someone truly be if they're always worried about making ends meet? Not very. You'll never get the best out of people if they're constantly stressed about money.

So, remove financial stress from the equation. Sometimes, that's all it takes to turn mediocre talent into Pareto Talent.

If you want to hire the best, pay at least 10 percent more than the high-water mark. Ideally, pay as much as you possibly can. Even if you're hiring domestically, pay more.

I believe everyone deserves the opportunity to earn well beyond their basic needs—to have extra money every month for fun, savings, and a better life.

That's why, if it's sustainable, I'll pay three to five times the going rate in regions where I can afford it.

When I first started hiring in the Philippines, my peers were paying their Executive Assistants \$400 a month for full-time work.

I started mine at \$1,500, with clear growth opportunities. By the time I sold Solutions 8, I had multiple employees in the Philippines making as much as their U.S. counterparts.

This is exactly why I had 40 percent margins in an industry that typically aims for 15 percent. Instead of chasing the cheapest talent available, I went after the best—in labor markets where I could afford to compete for them.

So, yes, pay more. But that alone isn't enough.

2. COMMUNITY: BUILD A WORKPLACE PEOPLE WANT TO BE PART OF

People are starving for community, and the workplace is one of the easiest places to build it—you already have the building blocks. Shared goals, daily interactions, collaboration, and even the challenges you face together create a natural foundation for connection.

When you lean into that, you get more out of your team, and work becomes a whole lot more enjoyable.

Connection is also a stronger retention driver than compensation. I have consistently seen employees who outgrew what I could afford to pay stay anyway—not for the money, but because they loved the community we had built together.

And here's the thing: Community isn't tied to a physical office.

Remote work doesn't have to be isolating. There's so much you can do to build team culture and connection (without forcing awkward Zoom happy hours).

At Solutions 8, we had themed Slack channels where employees shared their favorite music, books, and movies, posted pictures of their pets and kids, and swapped travel adventures (we had a ton of digital nomads).

Every Friday, we held a company all-hands meeting—an hour to review company performance and goals, get updates from department heads, and give anyone who wanted to speak the opportunity to chime in.

My absolute favorite part of the week was our “Open Mic” at the end of this all-hands meeting, where one employee would take five to ten minutes to present on anything they were passionate about.

We had someone perform a guitar solo, another teach the team about succulents, and tons of people share their passion projects. The most common presentation was a deep dive into a person’s city, town, or village of origin.

It was an amazing way to get to know people from around the world and truly helped us feel like we were all part of a bigger community.

Another critical part of building a community is having shared values. Goals define *where* you’re going; values define *how* you get there.

Without shared values, there’s no real cohesion—just a group of people working in the same place. A community without them is like a boat where everyone wants to reach the same destination but disagrees on how to navigate, leaving the team rowing in different directions.

And here’s a crazy, super-secret trick to make sure people understand and embody your company values: *Tell them what they are!* Frequently.

At Solutions 8, I worked our values into every conversation I could. And guess what? They stuck! People quickly adopted the same language and approach and became champions of our company, our brand, and our values.

3. PURPOSE: MAKE THE WORK MEANINGFUL

At Solutions 8, we had a small team responsible for call rating—a job that, on the surface, certainly wasn't glamorous. Their entire role was to listen to recorded phone calls generated by our advertising services and rate them according to specific criteria.

Not a fun job. It was routine, monotonous—and critically important.

At the time, we were one of only two agencies in the world (that I knew of) investing in having every single phone call we generated reviewed and scored by a real human being.

It was one of the things that made us the best. We were willing to do what didn't scale (one of my favorite soapboxes).

And I made sure our team knew that.

I talked about our call rating team on every single sales call. When I handed off sales, I made sure the new people carried on with that messaging. I talked about our call rating team in podcast interviews, on our YouTube channel, and on stage whenever I had the chance.

Most importantly, I let them know I was talking about them. Often.

We celebrated them on our weekly calls. When they caught a client mistake or helped us identify an error in a campaign, we highlighted it. They knew how important their job was, and were reminded of it regularly.

And as you can imagine—they took it seriously.

At any other agency, this would have been a churn-and-burn role. A revolving door of “duds” working a dead-end job for as long as they could stomach it before finally giving up and quitting.

But our call raters stayed for *years*.

In fact, the young man who ran our call rating team, Harsh, became one of the shining stars at Solutions 8. He constantly found creative ways to improve the job—discovering new software, refining analysis methods, and streamlining our spot-checking process.

Was he super passionate about listening to call recordings? No, I don't think he was.

But he was passionate about our agency, our clients, and our mission.

And because he was constantly being reminded of how important he was and how critical his role was, he took it as seriously as I've ever seen anyone take any job.

People are important. And it's important they feel that way.

True peak performers won't be interested in a role unless they can see how it connects to a broader purpose.

Work doesn't need to be complex or exciting to be meaningful. People just need to see and understand the value they bring to the table.

And if you're paying someone to do a job, it must be important—otherwise you wouldn't be paying for it. Even if the work seems menial, there's a reason it needs to be done.

When you show them how they fit into the bigger picture—how their contributions matter—they'll take the job that much more seriously. (Assuming, of course, you've hired the right people.)

4. FREEDOM: FLEXIBILITY MATTERS MORE THAN MONEY

Three-quarters (77 percent) of employees say flexible work is more important than a pay raise when considering a new role.¹ This finding comes from a People Management poll on LinkedIn with over 2,000 respondents.²

And it's not just one survey. Studies from *Harvard Business Review* and Grant Thornton report similar findings: the majority of employees prioritize flexibility over salary or other benefits.³

In today's labor market, freedom is more valuable than money.

But you didn't need stats from big-name publications to tell you that.

Chances are, freedom is the number one reason you became an entrepreneur in the first place.

You craved flexibility, autonomy, and control over your time.

Guess what? You're not alone. Everyone wants that—especially Pareto Talent.

Employees shouldn't have to ask permission to go to the dentist, take their son to soccer practice, or attend their daughter's ballet recital.

¹ Mayne, Mahalia. "Flexible Working More Important to Most Employees Than a Pay Rise – People Management Poll." *People Management*, February 13, 2024. <https://www.peoplemanagement.co.uk/article/1861233/flexible-working-important-employees-pay-rise-%E2%80%9393-people-management-poll>.

² "Grant Thornton Survey: Employees Value Flexibility over Salary Increases—One-Third Looking for New Jobs." *Business Wire*, October 6, 2021. <https://www.businesswire.com/news/home/20211006005291/en/Grant-Thornton-survey-Employees-value-flexibility-over-salary-increases-one-third-looking-for-new-jobs>.

³ Azpúrua, Ana Elena. "Charting the Value of Remote Work: Would You Take a Pay Cut?" *Harvard Business School Working Knowledge*, February 4, 2025. <https://www.library.hbs.edu/working-knowledge/charting-remote-works-value-would-you-take-pay-cut>.

If that's the work culture you've built, you're asking for "manageable" people.

You're also begging to be lied to.

That doesn't mean there aren't rules and boundaries for every role. I always tell employers: Be as flexible as the role allows.

If you're hiring someone to answer the phones, they need to be available when the phone rings. That's the job. It is what it is.

But you can still be flexible about shifts, scheduling, flex hours, paid time off, and other accommodations.

For more dynamic or output-driven roles, let employees be as autonomous as possible and manage based on results. If the job is getting done, why do you care when it happens?

When you give Pareto Talent ownership of their time, *you* reap the benefits—especially if you structure incentives like a game where performance is rewarded in a way that benefits both you and them. Let me explain...

Parkinson's Law states that work expands to fill the time allotted for its completion.

This means that Pareto Talent thrives when you're crystal clear about expectations and key performance indicators.

But you can take it a step further: by tying additional incentives to higher outputs, you create a system where employees naturally push themselves to achieve more—because they want to.

The result? Greater performance, fueled by a structure that rewards both freedom and results.

For example, at Solutions 8, our ad managers were paid based on the number of clients they managed. We never capped how many clients an ad manager could take on—as long as quality and retention numbers remained above average.

This system functioned like a game:

- The rules were clear—manage more clients, earn more, but only if quality stayed high.
- The rewards were real—high performers could increase their earnings without limit.
- The outcome was a win-win—employees had more freedom and financial upside, while I avoided the constant churn of hiring new ad managers.

The long-term payoff: more output, higher retention, and a performance-driven culture where the best talent was motivated to keep improving.

Put people in a position to manage themselves and—amazingly—they will! More importantly, they'll be *unbelievably* grateful for the opportunity.

I've seen it over and over again: offering employees freedom and flexibility *increases* their output.

A key facet of freedom is trust. If you're tempted to ask employees to install intrusive monitoring software or demand desktop screenshots, ask yourself: *How well would I respond in that same situation?*

I understand that in some cases, monitoring makes sense and is even necessary (like in the MSP-governed businesses).

But even then, proceed with caution. Trust is fragile. It needs to flow both ways. And, in my experience, it should start with the employer.

5. GROWTH: THE BEST TALENT WON'T STAY STAGNANT—AND THAT'S A GOOD THING

Anyone we would consider Pareto Talent is future-minded. That's part of what makes them Pareto Talent. These aren't lemmings. They're strategic thinkers who plan ahead—both for themselves and for your business.

Therefore, you need to show them there's a future with you.

I go out of my way to spotlight employees who started in seemingly menial roles and rose through the ranks—in job postings, during interviews, and even on our website. It sends a clear message: growth is possible here, and I actively support it.

I especially love promoting my Executive Assistants. My first EA became Director of Automations. The second moved into a Director of Social Media role. And the third? He became my CTO—and eventually, my business partner.

For Pareto Talent, growth is paramount. If they believe they're going to learn and advance in their career, that's worth as much as—if not more than—a giant paycheck. To attract these peak performers, you have to show them a bright, expansive future.

And, as risky as it may sound, the limitless future may not always be with your organization.

One of the top questions I get when I teach people how to hire is: “How do I retain Pareto Talent?”

Ready for the uncomfortable truth? *You don't.*

Pareto Talent doesn't want to be *retained*.

The definition of *retain* from the Oxford Dictionary is “to continue to have (something); keep possession of.”

Would *you* ever want to be retained?

Hell no. And neither would Pareto Talent.

As it turns out, the very idea of staying in one place is repellent to people who are growth-minded. It feels like some outdated form of indentured servitude.

This might get me in trouble, but I'm going to go for it anyway: Think about the type of person whose primary goal is job security. Who are you picturing? I'd bet it's some mix of government employees and union workers.

Not exactly Pareto Talent.

Pareto Talent's primary goal isn't job security—it's growth. That means you can only keep them for as long as you give them a path forward. Once that growth slows or stalls, they'll naturally start looking elsewhere.

And honestly? *They should.*

That's exactly what you or I would do. It's innate to who they are. If you could retain them forever, they wouldn't be Pareto Talent in the first place.

This uncomfortable truth scares many employers away from hiring Pareto Talent. Or even worse—some employers hire them but then sabotage the relationship the moment they realize they're being outgrown.

The better business decision? *Help them grow*—even if it means losing them.

That includes supporting their side hustles.

This is a huge area where trust shows up—and where many employers completely blow it. Never try to restrict employees from having side hustles.

First, it doesn't work. If someone is entrepreneurial, there's nothing you can do to stop them. All you'll accomplish is incentivizing them to hide it from you.

Second, employees with side hustles are almost always better employees.

They actually empathize with you as an employer (which is rare). They're also more industrious, more creative, and more autonomous.

I have two simple rules about side hustles:

1. Their side hustle can't compete directly with their full-time job. If there's a conflict, my company takes priority.
2. If (and when) their side hustle grows large enough that they decide to leave, they need to help find and train their replacement.

That's it.

I've helped dozens of employees launch their own businesses—and I'm very public about doing so. Not because I'm some altruistic saint, but because it's smart business.

By openly supporting side hustles, I eliminate secrecy and avoid big surprises like key personnel loss or sudden departures. Instead, employees are upfront about their intentions and timelines.

And here's an amazing fringe benefit I never expected: They almost always become awesome referral and strategic partners.

CASE IN POINT: DANISH ASHRAFI

Danish Ashrafi was something of a digital hacker and could solve just about any problem. I loved working with him but his freelance business grew faster than the role I had for him. So he struck out on his own.

I immediately became one of Danish's regular clients and frequently referred people to him. Then, one day, I got an email from him saying he had an opportunity that was bigger than he could handle.

The next thing I know, I'm cc'd on an email with Jay Abraham's CMO. (Yes, *that* Jay Abraham.)

One of the biggest referral opportunities of my life came from a Pakistani-based freelancer I used to work with.

And shame on me for thinking too small. That experience taught me how powerful these relationships can be.

CASE IN POINT: COLLIN SCHMELEBECK

You may have heard of Collin Schmelebeck—he's one of the biggest names in the Google Ads space. But what you probably don't know is that before he was Twitter famous, he worked for me.

When I hired Collin, he was already building his freelance business. He stayed with me for two years and was one of the best employees I've ever had. When he left, he did so on great terms—gave tons of notice, trained his replacement, and stayed available long after.

Collin wanted to keep his new business boutique, so he took on difficult clients we didn't want. Suddenly, I was monetizing dead leads just by sending them his way and collecting a referral fee.

Then, Collin started sending clients back to us. Even cooler? He coached me on how to grow my Twitter following, and within a few months, I doubled my following—largely because of him.

Now, what would have happened if I'd tried to *retain* Collin?

I probably wouldn't have hired him at all. And if I had, I would've forced him to build his business in secret.

Instead—by making it clear that I supported his growth—we both won. He gained a stepping stone to his next big thing (plus a steady stream of referral clients), and I benefited from his hard work, expertise, and referrals.

I've had former employees land jobs with larger organizations—then turn around and hire my agency. I've booked speaking gigs and podcast interviews thanks to people who used to work for me. I've even had past employees offer me equity in their new ventures.

Honestly, is any of that a surprise?

If you become an incubator for Pareto Talent—if you seek out the best, invest in their growth, and support their ambitions—this is the natural outcome. These are the kinds of results you can expect.

Not to mention the amazing impact they'll have on your business while they're there.

1.6 - AI AMPLIFIES EXCEPTIONAL PEOPLE

Okay, we're almost done building the foundation for Pareto Talent. But before we dive into the nitty gritty, let's address a question that keeps coming up as I beat this drum:

Why write a book about hiring people at the start of the AI craze?

The assumption behind this question is that AI is going to replace people.

That's wrong.

In reality, AI has made people more important than ever—by many multiples.

Maybe you've heard Bill Gates' famous saying: "Automation applied to an inefficient operation will magnify the inefficiency."

Well, in the context of AI, *people* are the operation, and AI is the automation. If people are inefficient, AI will magnify that inefficiency.

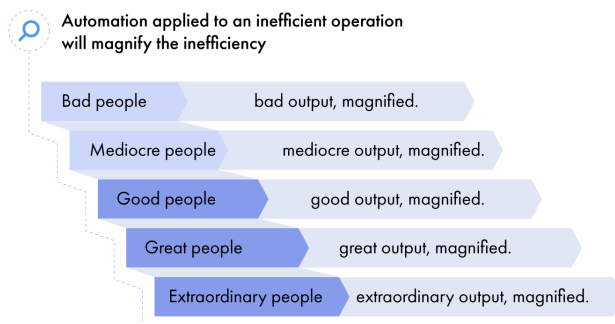
This should change the way we evaluate talent entirely.

Imagine you have an employee who's *just* “good enough.” They check the boxes, dot the i's, cross the t's. In a pre-AI driven world, they were at least a functional resource.

Now give that same *just okay* employee access to AI. Suddenly, their mediocre output multiplies exponentially. Congratulations—you've now scaled mediocrity to the ends of the earth.

In many ways, it's just simple math:

- Bad people = bad output, magnified.
- Mediocre people = mediocre output, magnified.
- Good people = good output, magnified.
- Great people = great output, magnified.
- Extraordinary people = extraordinary output, magnified.



AI means we can do more with fewer people. That's not speculation. It's an unavoidable truth. And while it's good news for entrepreneurs, it's also setting the stage for a widespread labor crisis. Because through the lens of an AI-driven world, most people aren't employable.

Why?

Because AI creates leverage. And when you can scale employees *exponentially*, you only want to scale the exceptional ones. Sadly, most people aren't exceptional—or at least, they don't behave exceptionally.

This is a massive paradigm shift.

On one hand, businesses can get way more done with far fewer people. On the other hand, those fewer people need to be true Pareto Talent—extraordinary humans who multiply value.

So, now we're searching for a needle in a stack of needles.

How do you filter through the masses and find only the best of the best? Especially when everyone on the job market is trying their hardest to convince the world—themselves included—that they are indeed Pareto Talent?

That, my friends, is where the Pareto Talent Framework comes in.

Oh, do you feel that?

It feels like the perfect moment for a segue.

GRAB THE **PARETO TALENT FRAMEWORK**

Everything you need to stop guessing and start hiring like a pro, **for FREE**:

- ✓ Plug-and-play **hiring templates & email scripts**
- ✓ Legally-reviewed **contractor agreement**
- ✓ Curated **global job board** with top talent
- ✓ Pareto Talent **SOPs and delegation documents**
- ✓ Shareable **PDF copy** of this entire book



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Thank you — truly.

— **Kasim**

STEP 2

CREATE A JOB POSTING

Remember that first question I asked—*Does this advice work in the real world?* Well, here's where we put it to the test.

A job posting isn't just a list of responsibilities and requirements. It's a marketing piece—a filter and a magnet. It should attract Pareto Talent while quietly repelling those who aren't a fit.

Most companies write job postings like legal disclaimers: sterile, boring, and focused on protecting the company instead of drawing in top-tier people. But I'm going to show you how to flip that script.

The right job post does more than describe the role. It sells your vision, sets expectations, and includes subtle “flytraps”—clever tests to help you spot detail-oriented, values-aligned candidates before they ever hit submit.

So let's roll up our sleeves and build something that works. Not in theory. In the real world.

Don't forget! I've created a set of free templates you can repurpose, including a Job Posting template. You'll get even more from this book by downloading the templates and following along as I break down each section.

Grab all the templates and resources here: TheHireBook.com/Free.

2.1 - SET YOUR FLYTRAPS

The entire global hiring process relies almost entirely on resumes and job interviews—both of which are deeply flawed.

Job interviews? Worthless until you've actually worked with someone. They tell you nothing other than who's good at interviews.

Resumes? Incomplete at best. How could a single page possibly capture the sum total of a person's value?

And yet, this is how we're all taught to hire—by filtering candidates based entirely on two unreliable indicators: interviews and resumes.

That's why the Pareto Talent Framework flips the script. Instead of relying on surface-level signals, it filters candidates based on actual, proven results, interactions, and behaviors.

I call these natural filters “flytraps”—built-in tests that reveal a candidate's true capability *before* you waste time reviewing resumes or conducting interviews.

Flytraps help you weed out bad hires before they ever make it through the door—without extra work on your end. And they'll help you automatically surface candidates who are detail-oriented, proactive, accountable, and resourceful.

This is especially critical for remote hiring, where you don't get to observe someone in person or micromanage their work habits.

Flytraps can be as simple as a hidden instruction in your job post (to see if someone is paying attention) or as advanced as a structured trial project (to gauge how they perform in day-to-day tasks).

Some are basic. Others are creative, strategic, and brutally effective.

As we unpack the framework, I'll call out the flytraps I use—and encourage you to create and add your own.

2.2 - PUT ON YOUR MARKETING HAT

We haven't even started yet and already most companies have failed miserably. If you'd like to see what I mean for yourself, go browse any job listing portal.

I'll tell you what you'll find: douchebaggery.

My suspicion is the person writing these job postings recently retired from their position as assistant warden at a federal penitentiary.

Here are some *actual* excerpts from real job postings:

- “Must be able to follow all company policies and procedures without exception.”
- “Failure to meet performance standards will result in immediate disciplinary action.”
- “Requires unwavering commitment to task completion with zero tolerance for error.”
- “Only candidates with at least five years of direct experience will be considered.”
- “Applicants must submit to all background checks and will be monitored throughout employment.”
- “Your job responsibilities include, but are not limited to, strict adherence to all assigned duties without deviation.”
- “Applicants who do not fully understand the importance of company loyalty need not apply.”

Yikes.

If your goal is to scare away Pareto Talent, feel free to copy and paste any of the above snippets.

Your job posting is a sales letter—it should be written with your marketing hat on, not your HR hat. (Honestly, why do you even own an HR hat? Throw that thing away. It makes your hair look fat.)

This is your ideal candidate's very first impression of your company. It should sing.

People should read your job posting and be filled with excitement and inspiration. You want them so motivated that they not only follow all your instructions, but also follow up on their submissions.

I'm not being dramatic—this is one of the most critical pieces of the entire hiring process.

Your job posting is a sales funnel. Like any other funnel, the more you put in at the top, the more (and better) quality outcomes you'll get at the bottom.

Here's the anatomy of the perfect job posting:

- Title
- Heading
- Who we are
- What we're looking for
- Job description
- Salary & growth opportunities
- Personality profile
- Make sure you're comfortable with...
- Our values
- To apply
- Close

Now that you have your lovely marketing hat on and your free templates in hand (TheHireBook.com/Free), let's go over each section in greater detail.

2.3 - CRAFT A TITLE THAT MAKES PEOPLE STOP IN THEIR TRACKS

I'll keep saying it: Your job posting is a sales letter! And like any sales letter, the title is the gateway. If it doesn't grab attention, people won't stop to read it—at least not the right people.

I've split-tested hundreds of job titles across countless roles, job portals, and geographies. The one that has consistently delivered the best results is:

“WANTED! The World's [Relevant Adjective] Remote [Position]”

Examples:

- WANTED! The World's Most Creative Remote Graphic Designer
- WANTED! The World's Most Patient Remote Client Manager
- WANTED! The World's Fastest Remote Video Editor
- WANTED! The World's Greatest Remote Google Ads Manager

Why does this work so well?

1. It grabs attention.

The “WANTED!” callout, complete with an exclamation point and all caps, is attention grabbing. Fun fact: all caps are so effective that some directories won't allow them. (In those cases, you'll just have to fly without them.)

2. The formatting increases engagement.

Notice the entire job title is written in title case (The First Letter In Every Word Is Capitalized). This isn't about aesthetics—title case

almost always increases click-through-rate (CTR), oftentimes by a multiple. (Yes, spending a few hundred million dollars in Google Ads will teach you a few things.)

3. People want to be wanted.

Even more important than formatting is meaning. It's not just about landing a job—it's about feeling valued in the role. These titles do exactly that. By calling out traits like creativity, patience, or speed, they feel like personal invitations: "*We see you. We want you.*" Instead of asking candidates to prove themselves, the company is seeking someone exceptional.

4. The descriptive adjective sets expectations.

Consider this our first flytrap! The mildly hyperbolic description of the role—"world's most creative," "world's most patient," "world's fastest," "world's greatest," etc.—immediately sets the bar. By explicitly stating that you're looking for the best, you naturally filter out those who are just looking for any job—attracting top performers while discouraging those who aren't confident they can meet the standard.

5. "Remote" is another built-in filter.

Notice the word "remote" is in every example. Not everyone wants (or can handle) remote work—especially in regions where the necessary resources aren't available. Including it helps candidates self-select out (flytrap number two—you're welcome).

Note: In some areas, "virtual" works better than "remote." Check local job listings to see what terminology is common in your target hiring area.

6. The job is crystal clear.

Your job title should clearly define the exact role you're hiring for. The more vague it is, the more you dilute your applicant pool. The clearer you are, the more likely you are to attract qualified candidates who are actually a good fit. For example, After Effects Editor is better than Video Editor is better than Editor.

For those of you trying to hire utility players—someone who “does it all”—stop. It's a waste of time for both you and the people you're trying to hire (ask me how I know). It's also unfair to potential prospective employees. A role needs clear expectations, and without them, neither you nor your hire will know if they're succeeding.

Note: The one exception is Executive Assistants. Their job *is* the ambiguity. They handle everything that falls outside a traditional job description.

Here's the reality: as soon as I publish this book, I fully expect a host of copycats to kill the effectiveness of this title formula. Don't feel like you need to copy it word-for-word. Instead, focus on *why* this formula works and apply those principles to craft your own awesome job title.

2.4 - USE YOUR HEADING TO FILTER

Every job posting I've ever published has had the exact same heading (the very first line underneath the title of the posting) and it's the single most important part of the entire listing. It reads:

“When you apply, please make sure the subject line is: ‘I actually read the instructions.’”

This is a not-so-subtle hint that there are specific instructions applicants need to follow to apply. A flytrap that alerts them to the other flytraps—*flytrap inception*.

And yet, even with this painfully obvious requirement spelled out, you'll be amazed (depressed?) at how many applicants copy the subject line perfectly, only to completely ignore the rest of the instructions.

This is the first hard filter in the process. If the subject line of a submission doesn't read, "I actually read the instructions," it's immediately filtered out. My EA doesn't even open it.

When hiring for a remote position, you need people who pay attention to details and follow instructions, no matter the job. This is the first of many filters to ensure you find that kind of talent.

2.5 - SHOW OFF WHO YOU ARE

Your job posting is a *what*? A sales letter! And now, it's time to start selling.

Before diving into the nitty gritty of the role and what you need, zoom out and give prospects a clear sense of who you are and why they'd want to work with you.

Here's what I used for a previous company:

We are a group of hard core problem-solving, custom-code-hacking, status-quo-bucking, out-of-the-box-thinking, genius digital gangsters, breaking out creative solutions with a vengeance and the passion of a thousand suns (covered in Tabasco sauce)...

More specifically, we are a digital marketing agency specializing in high-end Google Ads management and we are the BEST at what we do! We're headquartered in Scottsdale, Arizona, with team members across the globe.

We have a fast-growing team of nearly one hundred rock stars, all committed to working hard to ensure our clients succeed. We're looking for

other highly motivated, driven people who want to grow and make an impact. Is that you?!

Check out our website: [url].com

Now, let me tell you why this works.

First of all, you'll notice a heavy dose of personality right off the bat. Again, this is meant to attract *and repel* (flytrap alert!). I want to attract people who are going to be a strong culture fit and I want to scare people off who aren't going to vibe with our style.

More than that, it's a signal that *we have fun*. A true Pareto Talent reads this and instantly knows if this is their kind of company.

Notice that I also speak about my team in glowing terms to create a sense of unity and shared values. I want applicants to know how much we value our employees and that they're being invited to join a vibrant community.

On top of that, this description makes what we do clear and emphasizes our commitment to excellence, ensuring we attract top performers, not just party animals.

The reference to our headquarters is very intentional. For international talent, working for a U.S.-based company is often a huge draw, so I make sure to note our HQ location while reinforcing our team worldwide.

Lastly, I invite them to check out our website. I love finding out that an applicant has done their homework and researched us. This is a subtle challenge to do just that.

2.6 - TELL ‘EM WHAT YOU’RE LOOKING FOR (AND MAKE IT SOUND AWESOME)

Now it’s time to tell prospects what you’re looking for! But don’t mistake this section for the job description—that comes next.

The “What We’re Looking For” section is a plain-language overview of the job. And there’s a good reason for this.

Most job postings dive straight into the job description using clinical language, immediately outlining the nuts and bolts, required education, and ideal qualifications.

The problem with this approach is that the candidate hasn’t had a chance to picture themselves in the role yet. It’s like trying to sell someone a car by talking about insurance costs before the person has even taken it for a test drive.

Instead, give prospects a high-level overview of what the job looks like so they can decide if they can see themselves doing it. This doesn’t need to be overly detailed. For instance, here’s an example we used for a Client Manager role:

We need a new Client Manager! This is a remote (work-from-home) position.

Client Managers need to understand Google Ads well enough to interface with the technical team, answer client questions, help troubleshoot problems, and guide the campaign strategy. They don’t build or manage the campaigns themselves but act as a bridge—translating ad performance for the client and communicating the clients’ goals to the account specialists managing the campaigns.

This role requires a unique mix of right brain (client relationship management) and left brain (campaign strategy and data analysis)

skills. Client Managers are the lifeblood of our organization, and we're looking for more amazing team members to help us grow!

Notice the language—it reinforces the importance of the role and the people filling it: “We need...,” “unique mix...,” “very special people...,” “lifeblood of our organization...,” “amazing team members...,” “help us grow!”

I mean, c'mon! Have you ever read a job description this flattering? At this point, who *wouldn't* want this job? That's the goal—to get people excited about the opportunity to contribute and be a part of the team.

You'll also notice another reminder that this is a remote position. While these reminders may become less necessary as remote work becomes more of the norm, I still include them to ensure absolute clarity on the nature of the role.

2.7 - DEFINE THE ROLE WITHOUT OVERCOMPLICATING IT

Time for a deep dive. The job description breaks down into two key categories:

- Key responsibilities
- Qualifications, skills, and experience

KEY RESPONSIBILITIES

Remember, the more specific you are, the more successful you'll be in finding the right fit.

Ready for the super secret hack to define key responsibilities without getting lost in the weeds?

Start with the desired end results of the role:

- What is the output?
- What happens at the very end of the assembly line?
- What's the thing they're going to be stamping their name on?

Let me give you an example. Say I'm hiring a video editor for my YouTube channel. I release one video daily, so I need someone who can deliver five fully edited videos per week.

Therefore the end goal is to produce a complete, polished video package for each episode. That includes the main video, three to five shorts, plus titles, descriptions, and thumbnails—everything executed according to our SOPs.

So the key responsibilities are:

- Edit and deliver five fully polished YouTube videos per week.
- Create three to five short-form clips per long-form video (for TikTok, Instagram, YouTube Shorts).
- Write titles and descriptions that reflect our brand voice and follow SEO best practices.
- Design high-converting thumbnails for each video.
- Collaborate with the team, incorporate feedback, and turn around revisions quickly.

Starting with the end goal allows you to be clear about expectations without making the role feel totally overwhelming. It also helps attract high-potential talent that's still green but, unbeknownst to them, also very capable.

If your business is still small or you're figuring out exactly what you need, it's okay to be flexible in defining responsibilities. Just know that the less specific you are, the more diluted your applicant quality will be.

And don't go overboard with the number of responsibilities either—five is usually just right. For super in-depth or high-level roles, a few more is fine.

But if you're listing more than that, there's a good chance you're squeezing two roles into one.

QUALIFICATIONS, SKILLS, AND EXPERIENCE

With key responsibilities, I asked you to be specific. With qualifications, skills, and experience, the exact opposite is true.

Allow me the privilege of offending you (for your own good, of course). What you do just ain't that hard. I'm sorry, but it's true. If you insist that it is, you're going to have a very difficult time finding amazing people.

Here's why: Too many people are convinced that the role they're hiring for requires years of experience and a laundry list of mastered skills.

Bullshit.

A reasonably smart person could learn heart surgery in a few weeks with the right mentor and a little YouTube.

Okay, maybe I'm exaggerating—but only a little.

We have a built-in bias toward time on the field—especially when we have a lot of it ourselves. But time spent on the field isn't the prerequisite for success in a role.

In reality, the majority of your time on the field was spent making mistakes and learning what *doesn't* work. You've already pioneered that path! Now you get to be the grizzled veteran who trains the young and hungry up-and-coming talent on what actually does work.

In my experience, it's more difficult to integrate someone with a lot of experience because they come with so much baggage—bad habits—rigid expectations, entitlement, and an attachment to old processes.

That's not to say that skills, qualifications, and experience don't matter. They do. I'm just asking you to zoom out a little.

CASE IN POINT: HIRING A CLIENT MANAGER

When hiring for a Client Manager—especially for a high-end client—many require candidates to have previous experience managing paid traffic clients.

Why though?

Client Managers don't run ads. Their job is to keep clients happy.

So, what skills and experience do actually matter? I'll tell you—high-end customer service experience.

At Solutions 8, we skipped the paid traffic experience requirement and went straight to the customer service experience. And guess what? It dramatically expanded our candidate pool.

In fact, the single best Client Manager we ever had came to us from banking. She knew *nothing* about Google Ads—but she knew how to handle demanding clients. What's more, she brought a ton of new ideas and insights we hadn't considered before.

The idea that a candidate doesn't need past experience to be stellar applies to nearly every single role—even those requiring highly specialized skills.

For example, take a software engineer. Once a person understands the fundamentals of programming (problem solving, logic, process thinking,), learning a new language is easy if the employee is motivated.

Ask any software engineer who they'd rather have on their team:

1. Someone amazing at problem-solving and logic who needs to learn their tech stack?

2. Or someone perfectly versed in their tech stack but mediocre at problem-solving?

Same goes for:

- **Financial analysts**—if someone is a solid analytical thinker, shows great attention to detail, and deeply understands financial modeling, does it matter if they haven't used your super-special, proprietary, nobody-gives-a-shit fancy financial software?
- **Graphic designers**—if they're an amazingly creative master of composition, color theory, and typography, how tough would it be for them to teach themselves whatever design tool your team is using?
- **Social media managers**—do you want an industry expert who needs to be brought up to speed on all things social or someone who understands avatar research, storytelling, and content creation and needs to simply learn about your specific industry?

Pick a role—customer support, data analysts, project managers, copywriters, marketing managers, event planners, recruiters, and even sales reps! Ask—*what are the actual skills needed to be great at the job?*

I bet the list is way shorter than you think, as long as they're a motivated person who is willing to learn. Which, by the way, is the best part of this framework—because it attracts people who are motivated and willing to learn.

Getting specific on key responsibilities while staying broad on qualifications, skills, and experience will help you find the absolute best people for the role—without filtering out top talent based on irrelevant criteria.

WHAT THIS LOOKS LIKE IN PRACTICE

Let's bring it all together. Below are real-world job description examples that show exactly how to strike the right balance, inviting high-potential candidates who are motivated, capable, and ready to learn—even if they don't check every traditional box.

Financial Analyst

Key Responsibilities:

- Deliver accurate monthly financial reports that identify trends and actionable insights.
- Develop and maintain financial models to support decision-making.
- Ensure compliance with accounting standards and organizational policies.

Qualifications, Skills, and Experience:

- Strong analytical thinker with attention to detail.
- Proficient in working with numbers and financial concepts.
- Motivated to learn tools like Netsuite or QuickBooks on the job.

Social Media Manager

Key Responsibilities:

- Develop engaging content tailored to platform-specific audiences.
- Schedule and post content consistently across social channels.
- Analyze performance metrics and adjust strategy to maximize engagement.

Qualifications, Skills, and Experience:

- Passionate about storytelling and connecting with audiences.
- Strong understanding of trends and audience behavior.
- Willing to learn and adapt to new platforms like TikTok or LinkedIn.

Project Manager

Key Responsibilities:

- Oversee project timelines and ensure deliverables are met.
- Communicate progress and roadblocks to stakeholders.
- Coordinate resources and manage cross-functional teams.

Qualifications, Skills, and Experience:

- Highly organized with exceptional multitasking abilities.
- Strong communication and conflict-resolution skills.
- Open to learning project management tools like Asana or Monday.com.

2.8 - SHOW THEM THE MONEY—AND THE FUTURE!

This is the most exciting part of your sales letter—er, I mean, your job posting.

Turns out, many candidates skip straight to this part first before deciding whether to read anything else. (I know because we used session recording software on our job listing pages.)

First, tell them exactly what the job pays.

Remember, you need to pay *at least* 10 percent more than the high-water mark. Meaning, whatever a similar role in that area pays, don't just try to be above average—be higher than the highest typical threshold.

If you're not convinced on this point, quit now because nothing in this framework will work for you. We're going to put these applicants through a gauntlet of trials, and there needs to be a strong reason why they'd stick with the process.

Figuring out average salaries for a specific region isn't difficult—it just takes a little research. I always start by checking what other companies are paying.

If you can't find data on that exact position, look at comparable positions at the same professional level.

You can list the salary however you think is best—hourly, weekly, monthly, or annually. Generally, it's wise to match whatever you see the local market doing.

If other local job listings show weekly salaries, yours should too. Incidentally, this can also teach you how people in that region think about money—a labor pool that thinks in weekly terms can be very different from a labor pool that thinks in annual terms.

Generally (in my humble experience), the shorter the pay periods, the less sophisticated the labor—down to the temp agencies with signs outside saying, “Work today, get paid today.”

Never list salaries as ranges. Just put the amount: \$20 an hour, \$800 a week, \$3,000 a month, \$50k a year.

When you post a range, you create an immediate conflict opportunity—which is a horrible way to start a relationship with a new team member. This also signals the need to negotiate, which can intimidate certain candidates, especially creative types.

Anecdotally, I know employees who would rather take less money than be put in a position where they need to negotiate a salary.

I always use the following language:

“[Job title] starts at \$XXX per [interval].”

Note the “starts at.” I do this because I want them to know that ascension is built into the model and it's only going to get better from here.

The next thing I do is describe exactly what that ascension model looks like and what growth opportunities exist.

This does a few things.

- It sets people's mind at ease once they see they won't immediately be thrown into the deep end.
- It gives them a strong indication of what "winning" looks like and how their performance will be graded.
- It shows them how robust of a future they could have with our organization.

Especially when you're hiring in emerging markets, people aren't always used to finding jobs that are fulfilling and have strong potential for future growth.

Mapping out growth opportunities clearly helps attract growth-minded talent and keeps them motivated throughout the process.

Here's an example from the job posting I used to use for Client Managers:

Salary & growth opportunities:

Client Managers start at \$[XXX,XXX] a year

- You'll work under a full Client Manager as you learn the trade.
- You'll be assigned clients gradually as we build your confidence.
- You'll be graded on client retention and campaign performance.
- Once you're managing a full slate (25-30 clients), you'll be promoted to a full Client Manager.

Growth opportunities

- There are strong opportunities for growth for Client Managers who take on additional accounts.
- You'll continue to be graded on your client retention and campaign performance.
- We actively promote from within—successful Client Managers are first in line for promotion to our core strategy team.

Remember: Winners want to win! If you want top-tier talent, this section on salary and growth opportunities needs to make it crystal clear why working for you is a no-brainer.

2.9 - FILTER FOR PERSONALITY FIT BEFORE THE FIRST CONVO

I used to think personality tests were garbage pseudoscience. I was wrong.

Even so, they're not the end-all, be-all of hiring, either. But they do provide a strong snapshot of an applicant's potential strengths and weaknesses.

More importantly, they give you powerful information to use during the interview process (assuming the applicant makes it that far).

Predictive Index (PI) is my go-to. However, (trigger warning)—they're all pretty much the same. I prefer PI for its post-assessment features because they give you data that actually helps you make better hiring decisions.

If you choose to have candidates take a personality test, include a link in the job description.

I'll talk more about how to use assessment results in the interview step. For now, just consider the personality profile another flytrap.

If they complete it, they've proven they can follow instructions and are willing to invest in the process. If they don't, they get filtered out.

This section of the job posting also highlights the personality traits required for success in the role. It's an excellent "attract and repel" moment—the right candidates will see themselves in the description and get excited, while the wrong ones will realize this isn't for them.

Here's an example I've used in the past:

Successful [Job Title] Personality Profile

While there's never just one "right way" to do a job, certain patterns tend to emerge. Historically, the people most successful in this role share a specific set of personality traits.

They're driven by competition and results—pragmatic enforcers who focus on achievement, success, and helping others accomplish their goals. They speak directly, make decisions quickly, and naturally take charge. They're confident, persuasive, solutions-focused, and unafraid to lead.

What energizes top performers in this role:

- *Ambitious goals*
- *Challenges*
- *Professional growth*
- *Competition & winning*

2.10 - LAY YOUR CARDS ON THE TABLE

This is your opportunity to throw all your skunks out there—the potential deal-breakers, the tough realities, the aspects of the job that might give a candidate pause now or in the future.

A big mistake employers make is trying to hide or downplay the less pleasant aspects of a role. Huge mistake.

Instead, put these challenges out in the open and make them part of the application process to confirm that candidates are comfortable with everything you've described.

By being upfront, you avoid surprises, set clear expectations, and attract people who are genuinely aligned with the role. Honesty isn't just the best policy—it's how you build a team that lasts.

This becomes especially more important once they're actually hired. It's infinitely harder for people to complain about something when agreeing to those terms was a core part of the hiring process.

This is also why we pay top dollar—it allows us to be honest and still attract Pareto Talent.

For starters, I include the following two skunks in *all* of my job postings:

- **Remote working:** This is a remote (work-from-home) position. If you don't have a quiet environment with reliable power and internet, this isn't the right role for you.
- **Sixty-day trial period:** All job offers start with a sixty-day trial to make sure we're the right fit for each other. If you're in a comfortable job, don't quit unless you're confident in your ability to perform this role.

It's crucial to also address role-specific skunks upfront. Here are some examples you can copy and paste into your job description where relevant:

- **Customer troubleshooting or returns department:** It's not uncommon for customers to be upset or frustrated. While we maintain a zero-tolerance policy for abuse or disrespect, you'll need to be comfortable navigating conversations with unhappy humans.
- **Roles with off-hours or variable schedules (nights/weekends-/holidays):** This position requires a flexible schedule. Because we're committed to customer service, we need people who are available during nights, weekends, or holidays, and don't mind adjusting their hours when needed.
- **Sales roles:** This is a high-pressure position with strict performance metrics. If you're not comfortable meeting sales quotas or handling frequent rejection, this may not be the right fit for you.

- **Creative roles:** We work on tight deadlines and last-minute changes are common. If you're not comfortable with fast turnarounds and constructive feedback, this role might not suit you.
- **Project management roles:** You'll need to juggle multiple projects at once. Strong organizational skills and the ability to prioritize effectively are essential.
- **Cleaning up a messy department:** You'll be working with legacy systems that aren't always well-documented. A willingness to troubleshoot and self-teach is crucial.
- **Support roles:** You'll handle a high volume of repetitive tasks, like data entry or scheduling. If routine work isn't something you enjoy, this position may not be ideal.
- **Administrative roles:** This job involves interacting with multiple teams and clients daily. If you don't thrive in a role that requires constant communication and follow-up, it may not be the right fit.

2.11 - HIRE BY YOUR VALUES

Let's get touchy feely now.

When I was younger, I used to think company values were just bullshit lip service—a waste of whatever cardstock they were printed on. Sadly, that's probably because that's exactly how most companies treat them. As I've gotten older, I've changed my view.

Your values are the guiding light of your organization—or at least, they should be. If you don't have your values clearly defined, this is a full-stop moment. Stop reading. Stop thinking about hiring. Stop doing literally everything you're doing. Go figure out your values. *Yes, they're that important.*

They're that important because they should inform everything you do, inside and outside of your company. If you don't know where to start, my buddy Cameron Herold wrote an amazing book called *Vivid Vision*. Read it.

Since you're still reading *this* book, I'll assume that you've got the values code cracked.

You want to hire, manage, and fire in accordance with your values. To make sure you're doing that fairly, define exactly what they are up front. I've used roughly the same set of values for every company I've run for the past decade:

Truth: *Everything we do requires a commitment to truth as the core principle of our company. We are data-driven marketers—data is truth. If something isn't working, we tell the client. If we make a mistake, we're the first to bring it up and we own it. If we don't know the answer to something, we admit it readily (and then go figure it out). If we disagree, we say so. Truth is the first and most important step to solving any problem.*

Responsibility: *How do we do more? How do we give more? How do we help each other? Responsibility means constantly looking for opportunities to go further. We don't try to get out of work—we lean into it. You'll never hear us say, "That's not my job." By being proactive, we place ourselves in a position to influence the world around us in a way that only those who understand true responsibility ever can.*

Heart: *It's not enough to simply do—you have to care. Care about your clients. Care about your teammates. Care about yourself. Work like it matters—because it does. You need to know that you're making an impact—that people are relying on you to do what's best for them. We've been given a sacred trust in helping people grow their businesses, so we treat their businesses as our own.*

Just to be clear—don't copy and paste my values. They're here as an example. Take the time to craft your own and include them *in full* in your job description.

A personal note: The value of "heart" was originally going to be "love." That's how I first wrote it. That's how I thought about it. But then I got scared. I worried that "love" would be triggering—that it might give people the wrong impression. Like I'm some kind of crunchy granola, crystal-worshiping Sedona hippie... or something. So I softened it. And I regret that—deeply.

I wish I had been braver. I wish I had been truer to myself. Because that's what I wanted—I wanted people who were willing to be brave and, in so doing, *love*. Love our team, love our clients, love me. Even writing that now, I feel vulnerable. Yet, it also feels right. And, eventually, I changed it back to love.

That's when you know you've nailed your core values—when they're so real they could actually scare people away. Great! What a fantastic filter for who is and isn't the right fit for you and your organization.

I share this as a cautionary tale: Don't soften your values. Don't dilute them. Don't play scared. Go big. Be bold. It'll attract the right people and repel the wrong ones.

I love you.

2.12 - GET A LITTLE SNEAKY WITH YOUR APPLICATION INSTRUCTIONS

Welcome to the center of the flytrap.

This is where we drop the first list of overt instructions that we want candidates to follow to apply.

The actual instructions don't matter as much as making sure candidates can follow directions and pay attention to detail.

Here's the list I use:

If you're interested, please submit the following:

- A link to your resume in PDF format with the following naming convention: [Lastname.Firstname.ROLE-NAME.pdf].
- Details of your [job title/description] experience and why you think you'd be a good fit.
- A link to your completed personality quiz: [URL].
- A link to your completed CEFR language test: efset.org (Note: I only use this when necessary).
- Your answer to this question: If you were an animal, what animal would you be and why?
- Your answer to this question: What does this quote mean to you personally? "Work is love made visible." –Khalil Gibran
- Submissions should go to: [name+role@gmail.com].

Each flytrap serves a specific purpose. Next, I'll break them down so you can see how I use them—and how to adapt them for the specific roles you're hiring for.

A LINK TO YOUR RESUME

A link to your resume in PDF format with the following naming convention: [Lastname.Firstname.ROLE-NAME.pdf].

I ask for a link (not an attachment); I ask for a PDF (not .word, .pages, etc.); and I ask for a renamed file with a clear format. These specifics are all for good reason.

First and foremost, I want to see if the candidate can follow instructions.

This instantly filters out anyone who is playing “batch and blast” with their job hunt, along with those who think details don’t matter. Especially in remote work, the devil is in the details. It doesn’t matter how skilled someone is—if they can’t follow basic instructions, they’re going to be difficult to manage.

Asking for a link instead of an attachment adds a small technical hurdle and helps weed out candidates who have zero technical acumen.

Similarly, asking for a PDF forces candidates to reformat their document—an easy task for those who care about getting it right.

And then there’s one of my favorite filters: the folks who name their file exactly as instructed—“*Lastname.Firstname.ROLE-NAME.pdf*.” If they can’t see beyond the surface instructions to what’s really being asked, they’re not the right fit.

DETAILS OF YOUR EXPERIENCE

Details of your [job title / description] experience and why you think you’d be a good fit.

As I’ve said before, experience shouldn’t be the defining factor when it comes to finding solid talent. However, I do want to know why they’re attracted to the role and what makes them think they’d be a good fit.

This is more of a “get to know you” opportunity than anything else. It gives the candidate the chance to add context—who they are and why they’re interested in the position.

If they give a one-sentence answer, that’s a good indication that they’re the type of person who is going to do the minimum.

A LINK TO YOUR COMPLETED PERSONALITY QUIZ

A link to your completed personality quiz: [URL].

Again, I use Predictive Index (PI). You can use whatever you want.

I don't think the personality quiz needs to be a major factor in your decision-making. However, I think it can be critical during the interview process (more on that to come).

And, again, this is another opportunity to see if they follow instructions.

A LINK TO YOUR COMPLETED LANGUAGE ASSESSMENT

A link to your completed CEFR language test: efset.org.

One of the biggest concerns when hiring internationally is communication—and for good reason. It's tough to work with someone if you can't understand each other.

I'm optimistic about how AI will eventually help bridge language gaps. Until then, language proficiency remains an important factor to consider in your hiring process.

If you're hiring for a role where clear communication is critical—like client management or front-facing customer service—you may want to include a language assessment.

I recommend the CEFR assessment, which is the international standard and free at efset.org. The CEFR levels are:

- A1 (Beginner)
- A2 (Elementary)
- B1 (Intermediate)
- B2 (Upper Intermediate)
- C1 (Advanced)

- C2 (Proficient)

If someone is going to be talking directly with clients, I look for a C1 ranking or higher.

For internal roles where communication is limited to me and my team, I usually skip formal testing and just evaluate communication quality throughout the application and interview process.

In fact, I caution against any language testing unless it's essential to the role. I've had countless international applicants express concern about their English when, in my view, their communication was more than adequate. Don't scare off great candidates with irrelevant requirements.

You've got to let go of some sacred cows here. Some folks get really hung up on perfect grammar. My question: *Is that actually important to the role?*

If you're hiring a content writer, absolutely.

If you're hiring a designer or call rater, you can be a little more flexible.

IF YOU WERE AN ANIMAL...

Your answer to this question: If you were an animal, what animal would you be and why?

This question is a Trojan horse—and one that could probably get me sued or canceled (or both). So forgive me as I dance around this topic a little.

I love all people and find value in every demographic of human, regardless of their cultural or religious traditions. Hopefully that's enough lip service to appease the woke warriors before I get to my point.

Some people hold beliefs so rigidly conservative that they struggle to function within a workplace that aligns with modern progressive culture.

For example, they may have difficulty working with a homosexual colleague or having a female supervisor. Or other more benign issues like handling ad campaigns that feature someone in a bathing suit or even talking to a client with a penchant for mild profanity.

I don't have time to calibrate on issues that progressive society has already settled—and I assume you don't either.

The problem is, you can't just come right out and ask: "Are you an extremist, ideologue, or zealot?"

However, you can ask the seemingly innocuous question: "If you were an animal, what animal would you be and why?"

For the absolutists, this is an untenable question and you'll get responses like:

- "I wouldn't be an animal."
- "People aren't animals."
- Some other hyper-literal response that misses the point entirely.

These are folks I would advise you to filter out.

A fringe benefit of this flytrap is that quality candidates tend to give super creative responses. You get a little peek inside their mind and creativity, which is insightful and entertaining!

A SPECIAL QUOTE

Your answer to this question: What does this quote mean to you personally?

"Work is love made visible." –Khalil Gibran

This is one of my favorite quotes from one of my favorite authors. I use it to get a sense of how people think about work from a philosophical point of

view. You'd be shocked at some of the answers I've gotten—both good and bad.

One of the best responses I ever received came from a young woman who started as my EA and became my Director of Automations. She worked with me for years and was one of the best hires I ever made.

With her permission, I'm sharing her response below:

—Julianne Amador

Most people view work as something dreadful. They say that work takes all the sunshine out of Mondays. More often than not, people associate work with stress. Having a nine to five job is seen as a prison of sorts that everyone is constantly trying to get out of.

What people fail to see is that work is an act of service. Whatever your line of work, whatever industry you fall under, there is always someone out there whose life is made easier because of what you do. No matter how miniscule you believe your toiling might be, you play a valuable role that needs to be filled. The things that you do at your job—whether you work in an office, at home, or at the frontlines—is an act of love that you render to humankind.

Parents work in order to provide for their children. Doctors work in order for people to be able to spend more time seeing the world, experiencing life, and enjoying it with the ones they love most. Those in the service industry aid in giving you the best experience, whether you're dropping in for a quick bite or celebrating an anniversary.

Work, in all its forms, and in so many different ways, is love made visible. It is the foundation of a community—a global community. It is the one thing that everyone on this earth does, at one point or another, for themselves or for someone else.

I mean, c'mon! Tell me that's not someone you'd love to work with.

You don't have to use my quote. Use one of your own! A Bible verse. A favorite saying. Something that's meaningful to you.

Whatever it is, choose something that'll give you insight into how well this person aligns with you and your values.

SUBMISSIONS SHOULD GO TO...

Submissions should go to: [name+role@gmail.com].

I always direct applicants to send their submissions to an email address, never an online portal or HR submission software.

There are a few reasons for this.

HR portals make applying too easy. That's actually a part of their value proposition. They walk applicants through the same hoops I'm intentionally using as filters. Unless you're hiring for a role that's the work equivalent of Mad Libs, this is to your disadvantage.

Email submissions also tell you a thing or two about the applicant.

- In many cases, you see their email avatar (profile picture) and email signature, giving you an immediate sense of their professionalism (or lack thereof).
- If their email address is a custom domain (e.g., tina@tinabusiness.com), it might reveal their current side hustle or even their current employer. (Yes, this happens. *All of the time.*)
- You also get a better sense of their email etiquette and formatting skills. We're asking for a lot of information—do they just dump it all on you in a zip file, or do they format it in a way that's easy to digest?

Email submissions also give you way more flexibility with automations. If you're using Google email and Zapier, there's almost nothing you can't do.

Pro-Tip: if you're using a Google-powered email (Gmail or Google Workspace), you can create unlimited email addresses without any extra setup by using the "+" symbol.

For example, if your email address is "Ninja@FunnyBusiness.com", you can tell people to send emails to:

- Ninja+hiring@FunnyBusiness.com
- Ninja+designer@FunnyBusiness.com
- Ninja+LiterallyAnythingYouCanThinkOf@FunnyBusiness.com

All emails will land directly in your inbox, but you can filter and trigger automations like they're separate addresses—without having to create new accounts or manage multiple inboxes.

You're welcome.

A NOTE ON FLYTRAPS

Here's the thing: You're going to have some heartbreakers. Some amazing candidates will come through—people with epic resumes and tons of experience—who will fail to follow instructions.

How you handle this is completely up to you. You can make as many exceptions as you want. But in my experience, making exceptions almost never pays off.

To be honest, I don't even review submissions at all anymore. I've delegated this task to my EA and have very strict rules on who makes it through to the next round. Candidates will not be considered if:

- They don't follow the instructions, period.
- Their formatting is sloppy.
- Any of their responses are negative or sarcastic.

That's it.

2.13 - FINISH STRONG

Close your job posting on as positive a note as possible.

You're asking people to do a lot, but if you're doing it right, you're promising more in return. One of those promises should be a fun, upbeat place to work. If you haven't already, now's your chance to try and make that case.

You can also adjust your job posting based on the applications you see coming in. Don't be afraid to calibrate to improve your funnel!

For example, if I'm hiring for an extremely technical position and all of the applications I'm getting follow the instructions but have abysmal formatting, I might add something like this to my close:

Just FYI: I'm looking for people who can format their submission in a way that makes it easy to review. Remember, this role involves a lot of client-facing interaction, and we need someone who can make life easier for the client.

I also make it a habit to let candidates know that I'm willing to answer any questions.

This is critical because it allows job seekers to give feedback. I can't count how many times I've missed something or wasn't completely clear in a job posting—and a question from an applicant was what alerted me to the issue.

You want to make it inviting and approachable. Here's what I say:

As you can tell, we're eager to find the best candidate for the role. If there's something about the position or even the instructions that don't make

sense, please don't hesitate to reach out. I'm happy to answer any questions—just include them in your application.

You'll notice that I regularly switch back and forth between first and third person. That's on purpose—grammar be damned. I want people to know that we're a team while also feeling that they'll be communicating with one person.

Don't forget, I created a free template for you to use that includes examples of everything I've covered here. Get yours at TheHireBook.com/Free.

Once you've crafted your perfect job posting, it's time to get it in front of the right people. But where you post depends entirely on where you want to hire. That's what we'll talk about next.

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STEP 3

PLAN YOUR DISTRIBUTION STRATEGY

Before we talk about *where* to post your job, let's first focus on narrowing down your hiring pool.

The entire world is your labor market, and there are extraordinary people out there eager for a genuine opportunity at quality employment. Hiring internationally expands your options—but it also means weighing additional factors to find the right fit.

If you've never hired internationally, don't box yourself in too soon. Start broad, experiment, and see what works best for you.

To help you narrow your focus, we're going to break down the key factors that can impact your hiring decision:

- **Language:** Do they need to be fluent in English? Will accents or dialects matter in their role?
- **Infrastructure:** Do they have reliable internet and access to the tools they need to work efficiently?
- **Workforce Specialization:** Some regions have a deep talent pool for certain skills—tech, customer support, creative work, etc. Are you hiring in a place where those skills are common?

- Time: Will they need to overlap with your working hours? Are you okay with asynchronous work?
- Culture: Will they integrate well with your company's work style and values?

For an even deeper dive into specific hiring regions—including pros, cons, and what to expect—I've included a bonus chapter with detailed breakdowns. Be sure to check it out before making your final decision.

Buckle up, we're about to get a little politically incorrect. Heaven help me.

3.1 - DECIDE HOW IMPORTANT LANGUAGE PROFICIENCY IS

I mentioned language testing briefly in the job posting section, but there's more to consider beyond basic proficiency—some of which might make people uncomfortable.

In my experience, Asian accents (Filipino, East Indian, etc.) aren't as accessible to the Western ear and, in some cases, can trigger negative neuro associations—especially for older or more conservative-leaning people.

No, I don't think these folks are racists. There are a variety of factors at play, one being bad call center experiences. A lot of big companies have outsourced their call centers to Asia, and for better or worse, people associate those accents with telemarketers and frustrating support calls.

That's not to say you shouldn't hire people from these regions for customer-facing roles. Some of the best client managers I've worked with have come from the Philippines. But you do need to look at the practical realities of your business and make a judgment call.

Take my father, for example. He's from Pakistan and has what I'd call a mild accent (he's been in the U.S. since he was nineteen). Even so, some people just have a tough time understanding him—especially older demographics.

So, if I were running a hospice care company, I'd think twice before staffing customer service out of Pakistan or anywhere in Asia. Not because of lack of talent or ability, but because certain client bases might struggle with the accents.

At the same time, a mild Latin accent doesn't seem to be as difficult for the older demographic to understand. Thanks to proximity and immigration, people in the U.S. have way more exposure to Latin accents.

An Asian accent might make them think of a call center, while a Latin accent could remind them of their next door neighbor. That makes all of Latin America super viable—especially because you can find people whose accents are so mild they're almost nonexistent.

The opposite might be true if you're servicing customers in the United Kingdom, where people have had way more exposure to Indian and Pakistani accents but might struggle to understand someone with a Latin accent.

Or, your concern may not be the English language at all. Maybe you need a translator or someone who speaks another language—like French or Spanish—to support a specific market. Whatever the case, these same factors—accent, fluency, and how your client base will receive them—still apply.

The point is to think through your customer experience based on who your customers are and see if that helps you narrow down your geographic hiring focus.

When in doubt, stay broad. This will allow you to kiss some frogs and figure out which labor pools work best for you.

3.2 - CONSIDER WHAT INFRASTRUCTURE IS ACTUALLY NECESSARY

Those of us lucky enough to live in the “emerged” world take a lot for granted—reliable power and internet, accessible healthcare, safety from war and terrorism, and stable currencies and banking systems.

Not everyone in the world is so fortunate.

That doesn’t mean we should avoid hiring in areas that face these challenges. Actually, I’d argue the opposite—that’s where we can make the biggest impact by offering valuable employment opportunities.

In my experience, these also tend to be places where people work the hardest because they’re the most grateful. However, you need to be aware of potential obstacles so you can make an educated decision, have informed conversations, and mitigate risks where possible.

This is true even in seemingly advanced countries with strong infrastructures and stable environments. Even in India—one of the outsourcing hubs of the world—I’ve seen firsthand some of the struggles employees face on a daily basis.

As I write this in 2025...

- In India, those living in big cities (who also tend to be the most employable) get sick more often than their American counterparts. And when they do, accessing medical care, receiving treatment, and therefore recovering tends to take longer.
- In Pakistan, the internet or power may go out once or twice a month, depending on where someone lives and whether they can afford a backup generator. (Though this has improved in recent years.)
- In Colombia, many people don’t have heat in their homes, or if they do, they often don’t turn it on because it’s too expensive. So when it gets

cold, you'll see employees bundled up on Zoom calls like they're on a ski trip.

- In Argentina, extreme fluctuations in the exchange rate mean that if someone earns in a foreign currency—like USD—their salary could double and then be cut in half within months. (This seems to be stabilizing with recent political changes.)
- In Ukraine, the challenge here is obvious—the country is currently at war, with no end in sight.

My former CTO (who started as my EA) was in Kyiv when Russia attacked. By the grace of whatever deity governs providence, he and his pregnant wife escaped just before their apartment was blown up by missile fire.

I immediately filed for an H-1B visa to bring them to the U.S.—something my attorney said was less likely than winning the lottery. Yet today, he's living in Wisconsin with his wife, American-born son, Ukrainian-born cat, and their newly adopted pitbull.

Life is hard. It's a lot harder for many people who lost the geographic lottery.

I hope none of this discourages you from hiring internationally. In truth, all of these issues are manageable if you're willing to approach them with empathy and grace.

My hope in sharing these examples is to inspire and empower you to do the research, get a lay of the land, ask applicants the right questions, and manage people based on their real-world circumstances. (I cover some of this in more detail in the Bonus Chapter, but it's far from exhaustive—there's always more to learn about each region, country, and culture.)

[Soapbox alert]: I consider all of these small trade-offs when compared to the impact you can have on someone's life—and the even greater impact they might have on yours.

3.3 - IDENTIFY WHERE SKILLS ARE IN HIGH SUPPLY

Different countries naturally develop concentrations of certain skills based on education systems, economic priorities, and cultural influences, among many other things.

For example:

- Argentina produces a high number of economists.
- India is famous for its large population of software developers.
- The Philippines excels in creative tasks like graphic design and video editing.
- Ukraine is a hotspot for cyber security and blockchain expertise.
- Vietnam is known for mobile app development and animation studios.

Obviously, every country has brilliant people in practically every major industry. However, if you're looking for a very specific skill set, it might make sense to narrow your focus to regions where those skills are abundant.

For example, when running Solutions 8, I needed Google Ads experts. Google has four offices in India, and many of their Indian employees focus exclusively on the Google Ads platform—still Google's primary source of revenue.

Why reinvent the wheel? I simply narrowed my hiring focus to India and started poaching Google's best employees.

Inside Google, career growth for Google Ads specialists was limited—probably because there were so many of them. That made it easy

to find highly-skilled, veteran Google Ads experts who had hit a glass ceiling and were looking for better opportunities.

But before you get too myopic in your geographic scope, allow me to play devil's advocate. While I found the vast majority of my Google Ads specialists in India, two of my absolute best employees of all time came from Turkey.

That's why it pays to keep your search broad. Some of the most talented people I've worked with have come from the least expected places. When hiring for a role I've never filled before, I cast a wide net and refine my focus as I start identifying high-quality applicants.

3.4 - THINK IN TIME ZONES

One of the reasons I love hiring from Latin America for U.S.-based companies is the time zone alignment. On average, they're either in the same time zone or just a few hours ahead, making work hours much easier to manage.

The required working hours can have a significant impact on where you choose to hire. Some cultures thrive working off-hours, while others may struggle.

As a general rule, I prefer not to ask people to work shifts that conflict with their local customs and cultures. While it's certainly possible—entire industries, especially in India and the Philippines, are built around flex and graveyard shifts (like call centers, customer service, cybersecurity, and more)—it limits your talent pool and, in my opinion, affects work quality.

Anyone who's worked night shifts knows productivity often drops compared to normal hours.

Quick insight: In my experience, people in South Asia (India, Pakistan, Bangladesh, etc.) are more open to flexible and even graveyard shifts and tend to function well. However, people in Southeast Asia (Philippines, Thailand, Vietnam) and Eastern Europe may not be as receptive or as effective during what we consider "off" hours.

If your offer is good enough, you'll always find someone willing to work the shift. However, it's wise to set yourself up for success by keeping your applicant pool as large as possible.

That's why it's crucial to understand the specific needs of the role and align those with the time requirements.

For most roles I hire for, just a few hours of overlap is more than enough for meetings, check-ins, and collaboration.

This creates a natural and productive cadence—employees have time for deep work and then bookend their day with meetings and reviews for questions and clarifications.

- If you're on the East Coast (U.S.), your morning overlaps with India's early evening—perfect for connecting and coordinating, especially since Indians often work later.
- If you're on the West Coast (U.S.), your afternoon overlaps with the Philippines' morning, making it an ideal time to touch base.
- If you're in Europe, you have a broad window to work with across Asia, though there's less overlap with Latin America.

If the role you're hiring for is 100 percent time-based (like client management or customer service), that's fine. But be aware of the balance of risks involved, and make sure you clearly outline expectations.

3.5 - BE OPEN TO BEING THE BRIDGE

Every culture is different, and those differences can manifest in the work environment in a variety of ways. In some instances, you can request that people adjust to fit the role's requirements. In other cases, it may benefit you to accommodate their cultural preferences.

The key is recognizing that there's going to be give and take on both sides. Employers who assume employees will simply "fall in line" tend to struggle—or just don't get the most out of their international hires.

While some cultural differences may seem significant, I can tell you from experience that they're not insurmountable. In my experience, most of the growing pains are usually ironed out within the first ninety days.

You can and will be successful in bridging cultural gaps as long as you're willing to do two key things:

1. Be open and receptive to learning and understanding different perspectives and cultural norms.
2. Be hyper-communicative about your experiences and expectations.

The first comes naturally to most people. We're wired for empathy (even those who don't think they are) and generally offer the benefit of the doubt.

The second is where most people fail miserably. Communicating anything negative is one of the core human fears. Most people would rather avoid it altogether and then just let whatever happens, happen.

You won't truly understand where cultural mismatches are affecting your work until you start communicating and collaborating with people. Constant, open communication is the single most important factor in successful remote working relationships.

In an effort to help shorten your learning curve, I've included a Bonus Chapter dedicated to the hiring regions I'm familiar with, complete with

my personal insights on cultural nuances (and, dare I say, stereotypes). I hope you find it helpful.

3.6 - POST LIKE A PRO

The job boards you use depend entirely on where you want to hire (geographically speaking).

When you download the free resources, you'll get access to a filterable database of job boards, organized by region and category. Again, you can grab it all here: TheHireBook.com/Free.

To beat a dead horse: Stay broad until you've really struck oil and found a deep well of Pareto Talent.

To be clear—I'm asking you to stay broad in terms of *geography*, not job boards themselves.

The exception is LinkedIn, which has amazing pockets of talent across the world—especially in Latin America. Otherwise, the big job boards are mostly useless—filled with scam artists and low-quality candidates that'll drain your patience and waste your time.

I also don't like marketplaces (Upwork, Fiverr, etc.). They're great for one-off projects but terrible for hiring employees. The best talent on these platforms has already cracked the code on working remotely for themselves. They don't want a job—they want a client.

So, put your marketing hat back on (why'd you ever take it off?) and think of this like a sales funnel (because it is!). A good marketer would post the job to every viable traffic source out there. The more niche and focused the traffic, the better the results.

So, get niched and focused with your job boards! That might mean you need to post on a lot of them. (By the way, *you* shouldn't be doing this work at all. Your EA should. But we'll tackle that in my next book on delegation—wink-wink.)

I would also strongly encourage you to post to job portals that aren't traditionally meant for remote work. Some of the best employees I've ever hired didn't even know remote work was an option. They were searching for traditional employment and I converted them.

It's also worthwhile to post on job boards specific to the role you're hiring for. There are tons of specialty job boards for specific roles: content creators, graphic designers, software developers, appointment setters, sales closers, financial experts, and on and on it goes.

Pro-Tip: Not all job boards call themselves job boards. Look for online groups and communities that allow job postings. Think Facebook and LinkedIn groups, Slack and Discord communities, and WhatsApp and Telegram groups.

More often than not, the moderators of these groups will welcome you because you're bringing major value to their members. But always ask permission before posting. Spamming job boards will almost always backfire.

There are too many job boards to list here, so I've had my team compile a comprehensive list of every viable job board across all major regions and job specialties. You can access the full list here: TheHireBook.com/Free.

We'll keep it updated for as long as people are actually using it.

Pro-Tip: Use a custom email for every specific job board. Remember the email hack I taught you? Use that to create a unique email for every job board. This allows you to track which job boards are the best.

For example: Kasim+LIEditor@mycompany.com

That breaks down to: “Kasim + LI (LinkedIn) + Editor (the role you’re hiring for).”

You want your job posting on as many viable job boards as possible! This takes time, especially when you’re just starting out. But it’s absolutely worth it. Greater visibility means better-quality applicants in your hiring funnel.

If you’ve done your job right—with a killer sales page (er, job posting) and a solid reach across a bunch of job boards—you’ll be overwhelmed with submissions. I frequently receive thousands of applications for a single job.

That’s a great problem to have—but it’s still a problem.

We’ll talk about how to handle the overwhelm in the next section. Come along.

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STEP 4

FILTER THE STACK

Here's where the rubber meets the road.

If you've done everything right, you should be absolutely *swarmed* with applications.

If that's not the case, it's usually one of two things:

1. Your job posting isn't compelling enough.

Like any marketing funnel, you have to be confident in your offer. Are you paying 10 percent more than the high water mark? Are you meeting or exceeding industry standards for benefits, flexibility, and growth opportunities? Look at the job boards you've posted to and see how your job posting stacks up against competitors.

2. You aren't marketing it well enough.

When a good offer fails to yield results, it's almost always a traffic problem. Have you posted it to enough job boards to get adequate reach? It might be worth dropping some dollars for extended reach or promoted posts on the job boards that you're most interested in.

It can take a little iteration to crack the code on both your offer and where to post. But once you get it right, you'll have a different problem—being overwhelmed with applications.

This is where our flytraps do the heavy lifting with two intentional rounds of filtering.

4.1 - ROUND ONE: BINARY FILTERING

This stage of the game is black and white—either the applicant followed the instructions or they didn't.

Every application should be filtered according to the flytraps you set up in the job posting. Anyone who didn't follow 100 percent of the instructions is thrown out—without a second look.

Remember, we're looking for the best of the best—those who get it right the first time and don't need constant oversight. If someone can't follow simple instructions, they're not the right fit.

The easiest flytrap to filter for is the subject line. If it doesn't read, "I actually read the instructions," the email should be auto-archived and never opened.

If you know how to play the automation game, you can easily filter applications using tools like Gmail filters, Zapier, and ChatGPT. Without automation, you're stuck doing everything manually—sorting, filtering, and selecting candidates yourself (or delegating it). So make automation work for you! Just be sure to refine your process first—*then* automate.

Between automation and your EA, every single non-compliant application should be archived. By "non-compliant," I mean anyone who didn't follow *all* of your instructions to the absolute letter.

You should be ruthless here.

If they missed a *single* flytrap—like attaching a file instead of a link, skipping the personality test, or leaving a question unanswered—archive it.

This is the “first date,” so to speak. Meaning, this is the candidate on their best behavior. If they can’t follow simple instructions, that’s a red flag you shouldn’t ignore.

Pro-Tip: Always archive, never delete. It’s not uncommon for applicants to realize they’ve made mistakes and resubmit. I’m generally fine with that, but like to track that it happened. If you delete the emails, you lose that history.

4.2 - ROUND TWO: QUALITATIVE FILTERING

Binary filtering is relatively easy to automate or delegate. The second round, however, requires more nuance. At this stage, you’ll want someone who can apply more thoughtful judgement—or a well-trained GPT, if you’re so inclined.

You should archive an application if...

- The submission feels lazy or uninspired.
- The answers to key questions lack alignment with the role or your core values.
- The formatting is messy or hard to follow.
- There’s a strong sense that the candidate just isn’t the right fit.

Be mindful of the assumptions you’re making—especially when it comes to resumes and career paths.

Remember, tenacity and drive matter more than credentials. It’s easy to get attached to a mental picture of the “perfect” candidate, but that can cause you to overlook someone great.

Plenty of employers write off candidates with unconventional paths. Sure, someone who’s bounced between industries might *look* like a job-hopper—but they could also be a fast learner who adapts quickly.

Similarly, a candidate without formal experience might have built impressive projects on their own. That kind of initiative often beats years of clock-punching.

Once both filtering rounds are complete, you should have a solid list of candidates ready for the next stage.

I generally aim for five to ten applicants for every hire I make. You can keep more in the mix if you want—but it'll cost you. I'll explain why in the next section.

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STEP 5

RUN THE TRYOUTS

After filtering, I used to jump straight to interviews. I'd build a shortlist of candidates I liked, interview them, and then only offer the trial project to those who made the cut.

And? I was *always* surprised by the results.

It was rare that my favorite candidate from the interview process was the one who produced the best trial project. Surprisingly, some of the best trial projects came from candidates who had barely made the cut in interviews.

So, I decided to experiment. Instead of filtering people *after* interviews, I decided to offer the trial project to every single person I interviewed—regardless of how well they interviewed.

The results blew me away.

I got some of the best trial projects I'd ever seen—and they all came from candidates that I would have filtered out after the interview process.

That's when I learned one of the most important lessons of my career:

"If you judge a fish by its ability to climb a tree, it will live its whole life believing that it is stupid." –A quote often misattributed to Einstein

Interviewing is a skill unto itself—one that's unrelated to most of the roles we hire for. And yet, we rely on it to assess candidates for jobs where the actual skills required have nothing to do with interviewing.

This reminds me of something I read about hunting dogs...

Trainers used to select dogs based on their obedience in group drills, assuming the most responsive ones would be the easiest to train.

Once they had their obedient group of pups, they'd narrow them down further to the dogs with the best noses—since scent-tracking is the most important skill for a hunting dog.

Here's the crazy part:

At some point, someone realized the most “disobedient” dogs were actually the ones with the best sense of smell.

They weren't ignoring commands because they were stubborn—they were just distracted by the overwhelming flood of scents from all the animals around them.

When trainers started testing dogs in isolated environments, the entire selection process flipped on its head.

They had been eliminating the most skilled dogs using a filter that had nothing to do with the actual goal.

And unless you're hiring someone to be a professional interviewee, that's exactly what the interview process does.

It filters people based on completely irrelevant criteria.

That's why I started offering trial projects to every single person I interviewed—and it's no coincidence that's when I finally started hiring peak performers.

At one point, I wondered: *Why am I even doing these initial interviews?* I was never right about who was going to “win” the trial project, and I wasn’t getting anything useful out of first-round interviews that was influencing my decision making.

The follow-up interview after the trial project was always *way* more productive because we actually had something tangible to discuss—their trial project!

So, I stopped doing initial interviews altogether.

Now, as soon as filtering is complete, I invite the shortlist of candidates to complete a paid trial project.

This one shift has done more to level up my hiring than everything else combined. It changed who I said yes to—and more importantly, who I didn’t.

Let’s walk through how to design, run, and evaluate trial projects that cut through the noise and spotlight the real-deal performers hiding in your candidate pool.

5.1 - INVITE YOUR SHORTLIST TO A PAID TRIAL RUN

This is where things get fun. You’ve done the filtering, skipped the fluffy first interviews, and now it’s time to see who can actually do the work.

Below is the exact message I send to every single candidate on my shortlist to kick off a paid trial project. It’s clear, respectful, and sets the tone for a no-nonsense, high-trust hiring experience. Take a look—then we’ll break it down line by line.

Hi [Candidate],

I'm sorry for the late reply, [insert reasonable explanation here]. I really appreciate you following up!

Thank you for applying for this role! I'm impressed with your answers and attention to detail. I especially love [insert personal reference here].

Here's the next step, if you're game:

I'd like to pay you to complete a small trial project. I'll pay \$[XX] USD for what should amount to less than two hours of work.

I realize this is a little unorthodox. However, after twenty years of hiring, I've found that initial interviews rarely tell me much of anything. I'd rather cut straight to the chase and see how well we work together.

The trial project will be kept completely private and won't be used for commercial purposes—I truly just want to see how well we work together.

Is that something you're open to doing?

If so, please send me your PayPal address, and I'll submit the funds up front.

Let me know if you have any questions!

Once payment is taken care of, I'll send over instructions for the trial project.

Thanks,

[Signature]

Now, let's walk through it all in detail.

INTRO & APOLOGY

Hi [Candidate],

I'm sorry for the late reply, [Insert reasonable explanation here]. I really appreciate you following up!

The apology is optional. If, after the filtering process, I'm still overwhelmed with the number of viable applications, I'll simply wait and see who follows up.

This is especially important if the role requires tenacity, like client management or any type of sales—another great flytrap!

I always provide a reasonable and honest explanation. More often than not, it's simply the truth: the hiring process is intense and I've been overwhelmed with applications.

This is also why I offer appreciation for their follow up. I want them to know I respect their time, and I also want to commend them for any behaviour I would like to see repeated.

Pro-Tip: Behavioral psychology emphasizes that positive reinforcement is one of the most powerful human motivators. Encouraging behaviors with immediate and consistent rewards increases the likelihood of repetition. A friend calls this “catching them doing something right.” Even small actions—like following up on a job application—deserve sincere and honest appreciation.

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

Thank you for applying for this role! I'm impressed with your answers and attention to detail. I especially love [insert personal reference here].

Notice that I take the opportunity to thank the applicant again, reinforcing their attention to detail—an essential skill for remote roles. This is a

behavior I want them to continue, so I make sure to acknowledge it every time.

I also make sure to call out something specific from their application. This could be an answer to one of my questions, something from their resume, their formatting, and especially anything creative or out of the ordinary.

This makes the email feel personal and not just a template. It also recognizes the work they've done up to this point—no one wants to feel like their effort went unnoticed.

TRIAL PROJECT OFFER

Here's the next step, if you're game:

I'd like to pay you to perform a small trial project. I'll pay \$[XX] USD for what should amount to less than two hours of work.

I love the phrase “if you're game.” It's a subtle way of acknowledging the applicant's autonomy. I'm not dictating terms—I'm inviting them to participate.

And, yes, you read that right. We're paying them to do the trial project. This is essential for a few key reasons:

- It shows we value and respect their time.
- It allows us to hold them to a paid standard.
- It reassures them that we're not a scam.

Sadly, many people around the world have been taken advantage of by employers. Because our offer is so dang good, it's not uncommon for candidates to be skeptical.

Paying for the trial project helps alleviate concerns that this is some kind of bait-and-switch tactic to get free work—something I’ve definitely seen happen before.

Depending on your trial project, adjust the time requirement accordingly. I use two hours because it’s enough for a “real” project but not so much that it scares people away.

You don’t need to break the bank here. Just offer a rate that’s fair for the region you’re hiring in. In most places, ten to twenty dollars an hour is more than enough.

And no one is allowed to tell me that they’re worried about the costs here. As I mentioned earlier, I aim for no more than ten applicants per position.

Worst case scenario? That’s \$400. That’s nothing compared to the cost of a bad hire!

It’s either that or stick with the traditional model and hire someone first—then play the fun game I call: “Let’s find out if you suck at your job.”

That’s exactly why I started offering trial projects to every single person I interviewed—and paying them in advance. It turns out, that small gesture became one of the greatest flytraps I’ve ever come up with.

More on that very soon...

EXPLANATION

I realize this is a little unorthodox. However, after twenty years of hiring, I’ve found that interviews rarely tell me much of anything until we’ve had the opportunity to work together.

The trial project will be kept completely private and won’t be used for commercial purposes—I truly just want to see how well we work together.

I acknowledge that this isn't normal, but I also reinforce why I do it—I'm a veteran entrepreneur, I've been around the block a few times, and this is my process.

Telling people *why* something is important can go a long way in getting their buy-in.

When I first started offering trial projects, people would often ask, "Are you actually using the work from the trial project, or is this just a way to get cheap labor?"

To address this upfront, I make it clear that the trial project is solely for assessing fit—it won't be used for anything else.

I honestly still don't know why people care one way or another (especially since the project is paid). But it serves as a great reminder of how much pride talented people take in their work.

You may also notice the repetition in my desire to "see how well we work together." That's intentional. My hope here is to plant the seed that the output isn't the only thing I'm interested in—how we work together is just as important as the end result.

PAYMENT INSTRUCTIONS

Is that something you're open to doing?

If so, please send me your PayPal address and I'll submit the funds up front.

If PayPal isn't available in the candidate's country, I use a payment processor that is. Between Wise, Payoneer, and PayPal, you can get money to most of the world. But in every case, I choose the processor that works for me and that I know works in their country.

And guess what? This is an excellent flytrap!

I can't tell you how many applicants I've dropped because they made this simple request so much harder than it needs to be. I hate getting responses like, "I don't have a [whatever] account" or, "Can we use [something else] instead?"

A good rule for every employee, vendor, and lemonade stand: If I'm trying to give you money, you better make it easy on me. If I offer PayPal and you don't have an account—create one. If you can't, no problem—tell me why and offer an alternative solution.

But don't turn me into your tech support.

This quick little microtransaction can offer a ton of insight into how difficult someone is going to be to do business with. If you have to hold their hand through the process, imagine what's in store when they're actually on payroll.

It's not uncommon for people to turn down the money but still want to do the project. I love that! It shows they're willing to invest in the process. My only ask is that I can still expect the same level of quality I would from a paid project.

CLOSING AND NEXT STEPS

Let me know if you have any questions!

Once payment is taken care of, I'll send over instructions for the trial project.

Thanks,

[Signature]

I always make sure to welcome any questions people may have. It's really helpful to see what they're curious or confused about. Many of their questions will relate back to your original job post and give you a great opportunity to iterate and improve.

I also let them know that I'll be sending them the trial project instructions as soon as payment is taken care of.

This, my friends, is the second most diabolical flytrap I ever created (and I discovered it by accident).

Story time!

During one of my hiring sprees, an applicant sent me their PayPal email as requested. I paid them on the spot but completely forgot to follow up with the email explaining the trial project.

Then something amazing happened: *Nothing*.

They accepted the money—and I never heard from them again.

It wasn't until I was going over the project submissions from my shortlist that I realized what had happened. My immediate reaction? "Thank God I didn't hire them."

I was actually *relieved*.

What a good trade! Wouldn't you pay twenty dollars to find out if someone you're considering hiring is a potential thief? Or—if you prefer to give them the benefit of the doubt—just super forgetful?

Either way, it's not someone I want working for me.

So, that became my new standard operating procedure: I send the money. Then, I wait for them to follow up.

I'm happy to report that most people follow up within a few days—and just as glad to filter out the ones who would rather have a free couple of bucks than a shot at a great job.

Every now and then, someone circles back weeks later with something like, “Hey! I never heard from you on that trial project?”

Bullet. Dodged.

In case you haven't downloaded the free resources yet—for some totally “logical” reason—you can still grab this email template (and everything else) at TheHireBook.com/Free.

5.2 - DESIGN A TRIAL PROJECT THAT TESTS THE RIGHT SKILLS

The better your trial project, the more effective it will be at helping you find the best candidates. And yet, I still see people phoning this part in.

I don't love off-the-shelf assessments because they aren't a real indicator of the work to be done. (I'm talking about an irrelevant writing assignment or a multiple-choice quiz on industry jargon or a coding challenge that has nothing to do with real-world tasks.)

More often than not, the biggest mistake I see is that trial projects don't actually test for the most essential skills required for the job.

If you're not sure what to use for your trial project, look at the actual task list of someone already doing that job. What does their average week look like? Take that and condense it into two hours of work.

For instance:

- Graphic Designer – See how they conceptualize and visualize a project from a simple brief.

- Content Creator – Give them a complex topic and see if they can explain it to someone with zero experience.
- Media Buyer – Have them build a campaign plan that creatively integrates multiple ad networks.
- Client Manager – This one took me a while to figure out, but the answer was obvious in hindsight...

Client Managers are the bridge between clients and the technical team, meaning their role is all about soft skills. I struggled with how to test for that—until I looked at what my Client Managers did every day.

One thing stood out: Loom videos.

Everything funneled through Loom.

- Campaign issues? Send a Loom video translating the problem into layman's terms.
- Algorithm update? Loom video explaining the implications and next steps.
- Monthly report? Loom video highlighting key takeaways.

Client Managers were professional Loomers. Bingo!

So, I built the trial project around that.

I took real project updates from the tech team, stripped out references and attachments (forcing candidates to follow up), and asked them to record a Loom video as if they were the Client Manager.

The real test? How they handled bad news.

Could they deliver negative updates honestly—without sugarcoating or making the situation worse? Could they champion the solution with confidence?

This gave us a way to *actually* test the skills that mattered, instead of just crossing our fingers and hoping someone had the soft skills the role demanded.

Once you've created your trial project, you can use it over and over—just tweak it as needed to fill in gaps and test for skills you may have forgotten.

5.3 - SPRINKLE IN SOME INTENTIONAL FLYTRAPS

A well-designed trial project doesn't just test proficiency—it tests communication, problem-solving, and follow-through. That's why I like to build in a few flytraps to catch red flags before they become hiring mistakes.

The first one we'll discuss? Login credentials—my absolute favorite flytrap of all time.

Regardless of the trial project, I always include a step that requires logging into something. This can be as simple as downloading assets from Dropbox.

Here's my super sneaky ninja trick to turn this into a flytrap: I share the *wrong* login credentials. You heard me right.

And here's why.

With this one move, I can:

- See when they actually start working.
- See how quickly they verify they have everything they need.
- See how they handle a bump in the road.

Pure. Magic.

I also never provide a deadline.

Instead, I share the scope of work and ask the candidate to estimate how long the project will take.

This tells me two things:

1. Can the candidate assess a project and commit to a reasonable timeline?
2. Can they manage expectations and follow through on that commitment?

And this is where the real magic happens: catching procrastinators.

Let's say they receive the project on Monday, assess the situation, and promise a Friday delivery.

If I don't hear a word from them all week and then suddenly get a frantic email on Thursday about the login credentials not working, I know they've been putting it off until the last minute. Big red flag.

Procrastinators aren't Pareto Talent.

I also intentionally build in back-and-forth interactions during the trial project. This helps me understand if they're easy to work with.

Do they ask clarifying questions? Are they responsive and proactive in their communication? Can they take feedback and apply it?

In most cases, I have their would-be department head act as the primary point of contact for those interactions. This gives me a real-world sense of how they'd fit into the team.

Then, at the end of the trial project, I always ask candidates to record an overview video explaining what they did. This helps me understand their thought process and decision-making throughout the project.

If they struggle to explain their own work? Another red flag.

And if they refuse to turn on their camera, that might be a deal breaker—especially for customer-facing roles.

A well-designed trial project with intentional flytraps handles the next level of filtering for you!

5.4 - NARROW THE FIELD AND NOTIFY THOSE NOT MOVING FORWARD

Shortlisting the trial projects is easily the most arduous part of the entire process. Candidates have put a lot of time and effort into these projects, and it's important to properly honor that by thoroughly reviewing their work.

This should not be the entrepreneur or business owner's job. Instead, consider delegating it to the department head (if one exists), someone currently in the role you're hiring for (since they're the best judges), or a competent EA.

I always have reviewers take notes on each submission and share those notes with candidates—even if they don't move forward. Since they've made it this far in the process, they deserve constructive feedback as a professional courtesy.

This also protects your reputation. You don't want rejected candidates badmouthing your hiring process or discouraging other high-quality applicants from applying in the future.

You can find and download a free rejection letter template here: TheHireBook.com/Free.

After reviewing the trial projects and compiling notes, the reviewer should create a shortlist of candidates they believe are qualified for the role. In my experience, for every ten people who complete the trial project, three to five typically emerge as strong finalists.

At this stage, you likely have several Pareto Talent candidates in the mix. They've survived the myriad of flytraps, worked effectively with you, and delivered a strong final project.

But don't jump the gun and hire someone straight out of the trial project phase. I've made this mistake before, and it cost me.

Now, finally, it's time for interviews.

GRAB THE **PARETO TALENT FRAMEWORK**

Everything you need to stop guessing and start hiring like a pro, **for FREE**:

- ✓ Plug-and-play **hiring templates & email scripts**
- ✓ Legally-reviewed **contractor agreement**
- ✓ Curated **global job board** with top talent
- ✓ Pareto Talent **SOPs and delegation documents**
- ✓ Shareable **PDF copy** of this entire book



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STEP 6

CONDUCT THE INTERVIEWS

If you've made it this far—congrats. You're already doing more than 90 percent of hiring managers out there, who dive headfirst into interviews without laying a single brick of foundation. But in the Pareto Talent Framework, interviews aren't the starting point.

They're the final filter.

By now, you've already seen your top candidates in action. You know how they think, how they communicate, how they follow directions, and how they handle real work when no one's looking.

Which means the interview isn't about collecting new information—it's about confirming what you already suspect.

That said, don't phone it in.

This is your first live interaction. It sets the tone. You're not just evaluating them—they're sizing *you* up too.

Let's walk through how to invite them to the interview—and run it—in a way that respects their time, keeps the momentum rolling, and gives you the clearest possible signal on whether they're the real deal.

6.1 - MAKE THE REQUEST

First things first, you gotta actually make the ask. And, as usual, I've got a template for this too. (Work smarter, not harder.)

Hi [Candidate],

Thank you so much for your interest and, more importantly, your hard work !I can't tell you how much I appreciate the time you took to follow my instructions. As you can probably tell, I'm really looking for someone with strong attention to detail.

I reviewed your project with my team, and we loved it—especially [insert personal reference here]. After careful consideration, I believe you'd be an excellent fit for the role.

I'd love for you to schedule an interview. I prefer video interviews so we can meet "face to face."

Here's how to schedule:

- Please choose a time that works for you here: [booking link].
- Pick a video conferencing tool that you think is best suited for this purpose.
- Send me instructions on how to use your chosen tool.
- Treat me like a client whose technical proficiency you're unsure of.

This is a great opportunity for us to see how well you manage a client interaction. I'm specifically looking at how well you communicate and how clear your instructions are.

Let me know if you have any questions.

Thanks,

[Signature]

Once again, let's break this email down and walk through all the nuances at play.

THANK YOU AND PROJECT RESPONSE

Hi [Candidate],

Thank you so much for your interest and, more importantly, your hard work! I can't tell you how much I appreciate the time you took to follow my instructions. As you can tell, I'm really looking for someone with strong attention to detail.

I reviewed your project with my team and we loved it—especially [insert personal reference here]. After careful consideration, I believe you'd be an excellent fit for the role.

Candidates put a lot of hard work into their projects, so it's important to recognize that effort and highlight specific points of positive feedback. This reassures them that you carefully considered their submission. Include as much positive feedback as you can!

The last line—"I think you'd be an excellent fit for the role"—might sound like a job offer, but it's not. It's simply an affirmation that, up to this point, they're an excellent fit. That's why you're inviting them to the interview.

You're not committing to anything yet. However, it's important to position the interview in as positive a light as possible to keep the candidate in a good frame of mind. Remember, not everyone excels at interviewing, and you don't want a great candidate to bomb their shot or drop out at the finish line due to nerves.

BOOKING LINK

I'd love for you to schedule an interview. I prefer video interviews so we can meet "face to face."

Here's how to schedule:

- *Please choose a time that works for you here: [booking link].*
- *Pick a video conferencing tool that you think is best suited for this purpose.*
- *Send me instructions on how to use your chosen tool.*
- *Treat me like a client whose technical proficiency you're unsure of.*

This is a great opportunity for us to see how well you manage a client interaction. I'm specifically looking at how well you communicate and how clear your instructions are.

Let me know if you have any questions.

Thanks,

[Signature]

The “face to face” request is more important than it may seem. I’ve noticed a significant aversion to being on camera in certain regions, especially East Asia. Personally, I find this to be a dealbreaker in most cases.

Here’s why: Even if an employee isn’t in a customer-facing role, I prefer them to be willing to show up on camera. It helps build the necessary bonds that can otherwise go underdeveloped in remote work.

When employees attend virtual meetings—whether one-on-one or in a group—keeping their camera off creates a separation that negatively affects connection and participation.

Having the candidate set up the meeting is optional. I generally use this only for customer-facing roles as a simple flytrap—to see if they can make a basic decision (like selecting a tool) and clearly explain how to use it. For other roles, I just have them book time with me using a scheduling link.

The explanation piece is especially important. Note my wording: “Treat me like a client whose technical proficiency you’re unsure of.” I want to hire people who can communicate concepts effectively without being condescending.

Pro-Tip: For customer facing-roles—especially sales roles—I use another flytrap: having the candidate schedule the meeting with me, then canceling the day of. I apologize for the inconvenience and ask them to rebook.

Cancellations happen frequently in client management and even more so in sales. I like to see how candidates handle the situation—whether they respond with grace and professionalism or if their reaction is less than ideal. On more than one occasion, I’ve had people fail this test spectacularly. Another bullet dodged.

6.2 - BUILD RAPPORT

I love interviews—probably because I love people so much. One of the great things about the Pareto Talent Framework is that it takes all the pressure off the interview process for both parties.

Since we’ve already worked together, candidates generally have a greater sense of confidence and a stronger understanding of the role than they would in a cold interview.

At the same time, you can be relatively confident that everyone you’re interviewing could actually be a great fit for the role. At this stage in the game, it’s about hiring the person (or people) who are the best culture fits.

I also use the interview process to set expectations for the role and address potential risks that might arise in the early stages of employment. The interview sets the tone for the relationship and is an opportunity to ensure both sides are on the same page.

Because we're dealing with Pareto Talent, I prefer to think of interviews as more of a sales call than a talent vetting session. I want candidates to feel comfortable and connected, which will hopefully further excite them about the job.

That's why I always start interviews by discussing the trial project. I highlight anything I found particularly noteworthy, which immediately builds confidence and creates a positive atmosphere. The more confident and comfortable candidates feel, the more they open up and show their true selves.

This follows the same psychology behind establishing rapport in sales calls. But instead of faking interest in someone's hobbies, you have something specific and meaningful to talk about.

This makes the trial project the best rapport-building tool by far. Pareto Talent love to talk about their work. Asking thoughtful questions about their decisions—especially after making it clear you're happy with their output—is a great way to start to get to know someone.

6.3 - ASK AMAZING QUESTIONS

Once you've exhausted the topic of the trial project, you can dive into the more rote and routine interview questions. But thanks to this framework, you'll likely find that candidates respond with far more authenticity—and even vulnerability—than you're used to.

The interview questions you choose should be your own, ideally focused on your company culture and the role you're hiring for. Here are a few questions I like to use—think of them as a jumping-off point to spark ideas and get your creative juices flowing. I'll also share the reasoning behind each one.

Question #1: Flash forward five years into the future. Imagine that the world is perfect and everything has gone your way. Where are you? What are you doing? Paint that picture for me.

I want to understand people's *best-case scenario*. What's their dream? What are they aiming for? Where do they want to go?

In their response, candidates will share the skills they want to learn, the relationships they want to build, the projects they want to tackle, and the long-term goals they want to reach. Some may even share aspirations of starting their own business.

Pay close attention to their answers—many times, they're telling you exactly how to manage, incentivize, and support their growth within your organization.

This insight can help you shape their employee roadmap, creating a path that aligns their ambitions with your company's success.

A word of caution here: Some employers get turned off by candidates who express an interest in entrepreneurship. They're afraid of hiring someone who might someday become their direct competitor.

As I've already mentioned, this is so very shortsighted. Aspiring entrepreneurs are often the absolute best employees you'll ever have—they're motivated, eager to learn, and constantly looking for ways to improve.

Yes, I've said this before—but it's worth repeating. When someone shares their entrepreneurial aspirations, I let them know I'm fully supportive and happy to help them along the way.

At the same time, I'm also clear about a few non-negotiables:

- That they're willing to give me at least two years.
- That they won't steal any clients or employees.

- That they'll help find and train their replacement before they leave.

Question #2: I'm worried that you may be overqualified for this position. Obviously, that could be a huge benefit to me, but I worry that you could become bored, feel underutilized, or become complacent. I'm interested in hiring someone who wants to be here long-term. Can you talk to me about why this position is right for you?

This question only applies when the candidate is *actually* overqualified. However, when you follow the Pareto Talent Framework and offer the incentives necessary to attract true Pareto Talent, you'll be shocked at the quality of applicants—even for menial roles.

The sad truth about much of the international labor market is that many people don't have access to the level of opportunities they deserve. I've had literal PhDs apply for entry-level positions.

While it's exciting to find highly-skilled, capable candidates, it's also important to address their overqualification upfront. Having this conversation early helps prevent situations where they later decide certain parts of the job are beneath them.

This also forces the candidate to sell *you* on their willingness to start where the position is. And, if needed, you can refer back to this conversation if they ever try to improperly weaponize their qualifications or experience.

Question #3: I pride myself on building long-lasting relationships, and I think you'd be a great fit for this position. But things don't always go as planned. As you saw in the job posting, there's a sixty-day trial period. Can you talk me through the worst-case scenario? What happens if either of us chooses not to move forward after sixty days?

The last thing I want is for someone to leave a stable job to come work for me, only to discover the role isn't the right fit. I never want to be responsible for putting someone in this kind of situation.

This is especially important for candidates who have been with the same company for years or even decades. I want to ensure they're fully aware of the risks and are willing to take responsibility for their decisions.

This question has saved me a handful of times. I remember one instance in particular: I was hiring for a challenging role and was excited about a specific candidate. However, they had spent their entire adult life with the same employer and had a well-established career.

After discussing this question and weighing the risks, we both agreed that the potential downsides outweighed the benefits. While I was offering more money, the security they felt in their current position was invaluable to them and not worth trading for a bigger paycheck.

Question #4: Are you sure you're comfortable with [SKUNKS!]?

During the interview, I make it a point to go over every single "skunk" listed in the job posting and I ask the candidate to respond to each one of them individually.

This ensures we're on the same page as to the challenges associated with the role. It also helps manage expectations and set the stage for a smoother transition if they're hired.

People are far less likely to complain about something if they've already spent time during the interview explaining why it wouldn't be a big deal.

6.4 - REVIEW THE PERSONALITY ASSESSMENT

If you choose to have candidates take a personality test, the interview is a great time to review it with them. While I never use personality assessments

to make outright decisions, I find them helpful in identifying potential conflicts or challenges.

A good assessment tool lets you map personalities against each other, giving insight into where there could be friction between the candidate and their future manager.

Personality tests also make it easier to ask really hard questions without feeling like the bad guy. I'm not the one saying they're conflict-averse—the assessment is. I'm just asking about it.

I've found that addressing potential personality issues upfront makes managing them exponentially easier. If a candidate seems like a great fit but has a minor red flag—like a lack of attention to detail, a curt communication style, or chronic lateness—bringing it up early gives them a chance to adjust before it becomes a real problem.

Finally, always let candidates know where you are in the process and when they can expect to hear from you. Pareto Talent is in high demand—don't lose someone great because they assumed silence meant rejection.

And when you do know someone's a fit, trust your gut and make the offer. Then make their onboarding as smooth and energizing as possible. That first impression goes both ways.

GRAB THE **PARETO TALENT FRAMEWORK**

Everything you need to stop guessing and start hiring like a pro, **for FREE**:

- ✓ Plug-and-play **hiring templates & email scripts**
- ✓ Legally-reviewed **contractor agreement**
- ✓ Curated **global job board** with top talent
- ✓ Pareto Talent **SOPs and delegation documents**
- ✓ Shareable **PDF copy** of this entire book



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STEP 7

ONBOARD FOR SUCCESS

(THE FIRST NINETY DAYS)

Hiring isn't the finish line—it's the starting gate. And what happens in the first ninety days can make or break everything that follows.

Most business owners treat onboarding like a welcome tour or a checklist. But if you want your Pareto Talent to thrive, onboarding needs to feel more like a launch sequence. This is when habits are formed, expectations are set, and momentum is either built—or lost.

You've found someone with real potential. Now your job is to turn that potential into meaningful output—fast. Not through micromanagement, but by creating an environment where great people can do great work from day one.

Let's break down how to create clarity, set the pace, and give your new hires the structure they need to win early—and keep winning.

Pro-Tip: I'll hire multiple people for the same role if I'm in a growth phase. I would caution against doing this indiscriminately—you need to be confident in your ability to scale into the newly available bandwidth.

If it's feasible, though, hiring multiple people at the same time can be a huge advantage. It creates a team atmosphere during training, keeps a single new hire from feeling like “the new person,” and even instills a

sense of healthy competition—something Pareto Talent generally thrives in.

7.1 - PAPER PEOPLE UP

If you're hiring internationally, contractor agreements are all but unenforceable. Even in regions where some legal enforceability exists, the difficulty of pursuing legal actions often makes it impractical.

Even so, I still believe it's important to paper people up. It provides a level of formality that adds legitimacy to the job, sets clear expectations, and establishes a professional foundation for your working relationship.

In my library of free resources, I've included a contractor agreement template you can download for free at TheHireBook.com/Free. I strongly recommend customizing it to fit your needs and the specific roles you're hiring for.

The template addresses common questions like paid time off and maternity leave (which we'll dive into later). It also explains the specifics of the job offer and has helpful boilerplate clauses like non-disclosure, non-solicitation, non-recruitment, and non-compete covenants.

When you make a job offer, do it formally. Schedule a meeting to go through the agreement section by section, asking for questions along the way. This helps surface potential issues before they become real problems.

I also encourage candidates to have the agreement reviewed by a legal advisor if they choose. Transparency builds trust—and that's the foundation of a successful working relationship.

7.2 - SET THE PACE

Now, it's time to make sure your Pareto Talent can hit the ground running. If you're not used to working with peak performers, here's my advice: always give them more work than they could reasonably be expected to accomplish.

This isn't meant to overwhelm them. I explicitly tell them that no one is expected to work beyond eight-hour days or sacrifice nights and weekends. The key is ensuring they understand how to communicate effectively and manage expectations.

With the expectation set—that they work a normal full-time schedule (eight hours a day) and keep me updated on what they can and can't complete—if ten units of work can realistically be done in a day, I assign twelve.

Why? Because I believe that employees will never work harder or faster than they do in the first ninety days. Setting a strong pace from the start ensures they build the right work habits and expectations.

This ties directly into Parkinson's Law, which states that work expands to fill the time allotted for its completion. Yet, when hiring new employees, we often make the mistake of easing them in too slowly, afraid of overwhelming them.

This is a flawed model.

If you give people too little to do—especially in remote roles—they can start developing bad habits that are hard to break. You also risk setting an unspoken expectation that work will always move at that pace, making it feel like a bait-and-switch when you eventually start asking for more.

That doesn't mean you dump meaningless tasks or busywork on new hires either. That'll backfire—quickly. Actually, I strongly recommend doing the opposite. Let me explain.

Every entrepreneur I have ever known has a backlog of important projects they never get to. Start delegating those to your newly hired Pareto Talent. If you don't think they're capable of handling your biggest projects—try me.

That's the amazing thing about Pareto Talent. They'll absolutely blow you away with what they can do. You just have to give them the opportunity to prove it.

Speaking of delegation, that's exactly what my next book is about. I'm going to give up the game on how I've built so many successful businesses by leveraging amazing talent—*Pareto Talent!*—through the not-so-subtle art of delegation.

Because I'm awesome, I'm giving that book away for FREE. Subscribe to my newsletter to get notified when it's published: TheHireBook.com.

In the meantime, let's talk about a few more practical tips for managing your newly hired Pareto Talent.

7.3 - KEEP PTO SIMPLE AND FAIR

If you're building an international team, holidays can become something of an issue. Some countries and cultures have far more holidays than others.

What I found works best is to give employees a bucket of days they can use at their discretion. The number we landed on was twenty paid days off per year, which can be used for anything from personal days to national and religious holidays.

These days are accrued at a rate of 1.7 days per month and do not roll over. Meaning, it's a "use it or lose it" benefit. You can certainly structure PTO differently, but I prefer this approach to avoid the logistical headache of tracking or paying out unused time off.

In many areas, twenty days is more than adequate. In others, candidates may try to negotiate for more. Again, this is up to you and how you feel about the new hire. Personally, I prefer to keep everyone on the same plan to avoid issues or complaints.

One very important note to address is maternity and paternity leave. In many countries, employees are guaranteed parental leave by law—sometimes exceeding a year. This isn't viable for most employers, so it's important to be clear about this from the start.

While the contractor agreement I use simply states that maternity and paternity leave isn't an offered benefit, I always take this on a case-by-case basis. For employees who are truly committed and want to return, we always find a fair and equitable solution.

7.4 - PAY ON TIME

Getting paid is a sensitive issue, especially for international employees. I can't begin to relay the number of stories I've heard about employees being strung along for months, only to never receive full recompense.

This is especially true for employees who have never worked virtually or for an international company. It's absolutely imperative that you always pay on time—or even early—to build trust and help assuage these fears.

For payment processing, you'll need a tool that functions in the country or countries you're hiring from. In order of preference, we use: Payoneer, then

Wise, then PayPal. These platforms cover 90 percent of the functional globe.

I also strongly recommend that you cover any associated payment or transfer fees. While they're generally only a small percentage of the total transfer, they can amount to significant sums in emerging nations where the dollar wields more power.

7.5 - STAY CONNECTED

Communication is *everything* when it comes to remote work. For new hires, I recommend daily check-ins—at least until you and they feel confident in their ability to meet expectations.

These meetings don't need to be long, but they help establish accountability and provide employees the opportunity to ask questions. My strong recommendation? Give employees feedback early and often.

Avoid the trap of thinking you're nitpicking. Instead, frame it as calibration. And whenever possible, pair constructive feedback with positive reinforcement.

If you're worried something sounds too minor, tie it back to the result or impact you're trying to avoid. For example, "I realize font usage might seem like such a small thing. But remember, we're working with brand advocates who obsess over details like that."

Helping people understand the "why" behind best practices increases the likelihood they'll follow them. And if you *can't* connect a strong "why"? That might be a sign you *are* nitpicking.

Ideally, check-ins happen with a department head or someone directly involved in the work the new hire is assigned. Otherwise, the feedback will be diluted and ineffective.

Once daily meetings are no longer necessary, adjust the cadence to fit your team's workflow. I recommend keeping two weekly standing meetings—one with the internal team and one with the entire company. (I'll cover this more in the next section.)

Additionally, make sure to formally announce when an employee passes their sixty-day trial. The trial period can be nerve-wracking (which is more of a feature than a bug).

Once an employee has truly earned their place and you know they're sticking around long-term, let them know—loud and clear! This can even be a fun moment of celebration, if you choose to make it one.

7.6 - BUILD TEAM SPIRIT

In an office, interaction, camaraderie, and casual conversation happen naturally. Remotely? You have to be extremely intentional about *making* this happen. That's not to say it can't happen remotely—it can (and should). But it needs to be infused with purpose and commitment.

Over the years, I've found a handful of strategies that have worked well for strengthening remote teams.

1. The All-Hands Meeting

The most impactful has been our company-wide “all hands” meeting—something I implement in every company I own. Think of it as a weekly Town Hall where everyone is politely required to attend.

The agenda varies slightly by company, but it typically follows this format:

- A quick (five-minute) game to bolster engagement.
- A company health check where we review goals and KPIs.
- News and announcements to keep everyone in the loop.

- Department updates from team leads.
- Questions and discussion items.
- My favorite part of the week—Open Mic time.

2. Open Mic

I mentioned this before, but it's worth repeating because it's such a fun and valuable activity. During Open Mic, one employee gets up to ten minutes to talk about anything they want—just so we can get to know them better.

We've seen employees use this time to share their passions, talents, and personal stories in ways that make the team feel more connected.

And it never ceases to amaze me how much talent, creativity, and personality people bring to the table—and how much we might have missed if not for this time.

3. Team Connections

Beyond these weekly calls, we encourage standing calls among teams, pods, and even temporary project groups. While I value asynchronous communication, a few short “face-to-face” meetings can do a lot to bridge the sterility of digital communication and help people feel like they're a part of a real team.

We also have Slack channels dedicated to fun topics like pets, books, shows, music, and travel. These small touchpoints help employees connect beyond work—and it's amazing how much shared interests improve collaboration and communication.

7.7 - BE THE INCUBATOR

There's really no stopping Pareto Talent—something I'm excited for you to see for yourself.

But this is a double-edged sword.

On one hand, you'll have some of the most talented, driven people you'll ever work with. On the other, their desire for growth will likely outpace your ability to keep up.

That's why there are two key things to keep in mind when managing and developing Pareto Talent:

First, never underestimate them.

Just because you hired someone for a small or seemingly menial role doesn't mean they aren't capable of infinitely more important things as they grow and evolve.

Therefore, before you look outside your company to fill a high-level need, *look within*. The perfect candidate might be hiding in plain sight—just waiting for the opportunity to prove themselves.

The second thing that's important to remember is that you can't "retain" top talent. The word itself implies a sense of employer entitlement—something we should all work to eliminate altogether.

Just because you trained someone, helped develop their skills, or invested in their growth doesn't mean you own them.

Instead of fighting inevitable departures, *support their journey*. If someone is ready for growth that your company can't provide, help them take their next step. This prevents "midnight move-outs" and ensures a smooth, respectful transition.

It'll also help you build a reputation as a company that Pareto Talent can look to as an incubator. The kind of place they can go to learn and develop skills that will benefit them far into the future—beyond any single employment opportunity.

When you approach onboarding this way, you unlock potential from day one—unleashing your Pareto Talent to raise the bar, reshape what’s possible, and leave your business better than they found it.

GRAB THE **PARETO TALENT FRAMEWORK**

Everything you need to stop guessing and start hiring like a pro, **for FREE**:

- ✓ Plug-and-play **hiring templates & email scripts**
- ✓ Legally-reviewed **contractor agreement**
- ✓ Curated **global job board** with top talent
- ✓ Pareto Talent **SOPs** and **delegation documents**
- ✓ Shareable **PDF copy** of this entire book



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CONCLUSION

People truly are miracles. Or they can be, if you're willing to give them the opportunity. I hope the Pareto Talent Framework helps you realize the full potential of what human beings are capable of.

If you follow these steps, I believe you'll find more capable talent than you ever thought possible.

But here's the thing: hiring isn't just about finding great people. It's about becoming the kind of leader who welcomes greatness. The right people can only thrive in the right environment, and it's your responsibility to create that.

Your culture, systems, and leadership set the stage for what's possible.

Remember, hiring isn't a one-and-done process. It's a commitment to continuous improvement. It's about refining your job postings, modifying your flytraps, updating your trial project, and being honest about what you truly need versus what you *think* you need.

It's about seeing people not as commodities but as partners in achieving a shared vision.

The best hires aren't just talented—they're aligned. Aligned with your mission, your values, and your purpose. That alignment is the magic ingredient that turns a hire into a teammate, a contributor, and sometimes, a lifelong ally.

As you move forward, embrace hiring as an act of hope and belief—hope in what people can achieve and belief in your ability to lead them toward it.

Hiring is so much more than a business process; it's an invitation to co-create something extraordinary.

So, go out there and build your dream team. Take these lessons, adapt them to your unique needs, and trust the process. When you get hiring right, you aren't just going to benefit your business, you're going to benefit every human being who works for you and the people connected to them.

And in terms of long-term, scalable impact? I know of few endeavours that have a greater impact than creating meaningful employment opportunities. You truly can change the world, one person at a time.

Thank you for trusting me to guide you on this journey. Here's to your success and the incredible people who will help you achieve it.

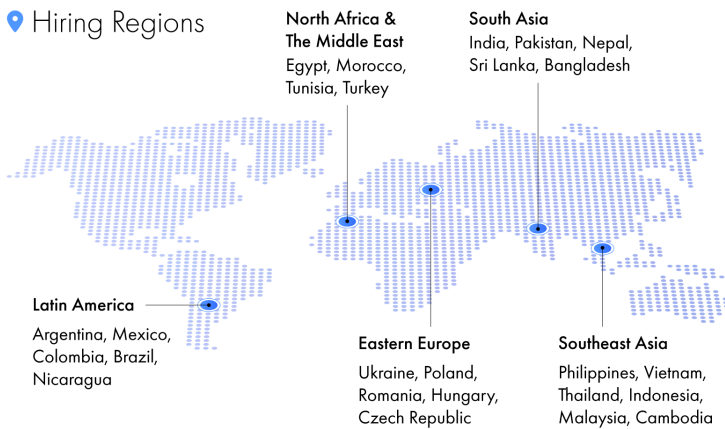
I love you.

—Kasim

BONUS SECTION

(for all you overachievers out there)

HIRING REGIONS



Before I dive into specific examples from my personal experiences, I want to acknowledge that this is a complex topic. These are broad generalizations and my goal is to offer insights that help bridge cultural gaps, not to make assumptions about individuals.

I'm approaching this topic with humility and respect, fully aware there's plenty of room for missteps. Please know that my aim is to foster understanding. If anything I share misses the mark, I apologize in advance.

These observations are also far from exhaustive. Every person you hire is an individual. While cultural norms exist, they don't manifest the same way in every person—so treat this as context, not a rulebook.

Below are the regions I'm most familiar with, along with some of the most popular countries for hiring remote workers in each:

- **Southeast Asia:** Philippines, Vietnam, Thailand, Indonesia, Malaysia, Cambodia
- **South Asia:** India, Pakistan, Sri Lanka, Bangladesh, Nepal
- **Latin America:** Argentina, Mexico, Colombia, Brazil, Nicaragua
- **Eastern Europe:** Ukraine, Poland, Romania, Hungary, Czech Republic
- **North Africa & The Middle East:** Egypt, Morocco, Tunisia, Turkey
- **Plus!** A *bonus* region I bet you've never thought of!

For each region, I'll share my experience with salary considerations, conflict style, cultural hierarchy, communication, family life, and other general observations.

SOUTHEAST ASIA

Most of my Southeast Asian hiring experience is rooted in the Philippines. Still, many of the cultural nuances I've described also show up across the broader region, according to trusted colleagues and fellow employers.

The Philippines is one of the most popular outsourcing destinations for U.S.-based companies—and for good reason. I've found some of my most

talented team members there. But as more Western companies set up shop and open offices, talent availability has become more competitive.

If you're hiring in the region, it might be worth expanding your geofence a bit—to neighboring countries with similar talent pools—so you're not constantly battling bigger companies for the same people.

SALARY AND INCENTIVE CONSIDERATIONS

In the Philippines, employees receive an extra month's salary at the end of every year—something they call “the 13th month.” It's a big deal. Most people count on it, especially because it hits right around the holiday season. If you're hiring in the Philippines, you'll want to account for this in your compensation planning.

CONFLICT & COMMUNICATION STYLE

Filipinos are famously conflict-averse. There's even a term for it: *Pakikisama*, which loosely translates to “getting along with others” or “keeping the peace.” Because of this, things like constructive criticism, performance reviews, or even offering feedback need to be approached with a little more care and sensitivity than you might be used to.

A Filipino colleague once put it this way: “Filipinos view Americans the way Americans view Germans.” Meaning—if Americans see Germans as *too* direct, that's how we come across to Filipinos. It's not personal, but it *is* cultural.

Filipino employees often struggle with setting boundaries, pushing back, or self-advocating. That means they may suffer in silence—even if they're drowning.

One of the best employees I've ever had was Angelia. She started as a virtual assistant, moved to our onboarding team, and eventually became Director of our entire onboarding department. She was a rockstar.

But early on, during a period of intense growth, I made the rookie mistake of only responding to the squeaky wheels. It wasn't until months later that I found out Angelia's workload had tripled. She was trying to keep up—quietly—and burning out fast.

This is a real risk. If you're not paying attention, you could lose incredible people simply because you didn't realize they were struggling. I've seen it happen to plenty of friends and colleagues.

Some leaders get frustrated with this. "Why didn't they just say something?" they ask. But that frustration misses the point. Cultural norms run deep, and in many cases, people genuinely feel they don't have another option.

That's why this awareness matters. As leaders, we have to adjust our approach—check in more often, listen more carefully, and make space for open, safe communication.

POWER & LEADERSHIP

In more traditional Filipino work environments, people are expected to follow directions exactly as given. There's often not much room (or encouragement) for innovation because coloring outside the lines feels risky—and may even be punished.

Which is a shame, because I've found the Philippines to be full of creative talent. But to see it, you have to earn trust and create a culture where creativity is celebrated and mistakes aren't punished.

Don't expect process improvement suggestions or out-of-the-box thinking right out of the gate. That kind of innovation needs to be nurtured and modeled. Once it is, the results can be incredible.

FAMILY LIFE

Filipino culture is deeply family-oriented. It's common for employees to share a large portion of their income with extended family. Money is often viewed as a shared resource, not a personal one.

This is helpful to keep in mind when building incentive programs. Non-cash rewards—like physical gifts or gift cards—can carry more personal meaning, since they feel like something the employee gets to enjoy for themselves, rather than something they're expected to contribute to the family pot.

REGIONAL RECAP: SOUTHEAST ASIA

Southeast Asian employees—especially in the Philippines—thrive in environments built on trust, safety, and clarity. Take time to build rapport, provide clear instructions, and create space for gradual autonomy. Initiative and creativity will follow once psychological safety is firmly in place.

SOUTH ASIA

South Asian professionals are adaptable, resourceful, and thrive in dynamic environments. Many embody what's known as the “Jugaad mentality”—a creative, flexible approach to problem-solving using limited resources. It's scrappy and effective, but can sometimes lead to quick fixes that aren't built for the long haul.

South Asian employees do incredibly well when given structure—but they also shine in cultures that reward innovation, offer mentorship, and give them room to grow.

Time tends to be seen more fluidly in this region and deadlines are often treated as guidelines. That’s not laziness—it’s cultural. To stay aligned, set clear expectations, build in buffers, and check in early and often.

SALARY & INCENTIVE CONSIDERATIONS

Salary expectations vary widely across South Asia. In countries like India and Pakistan, competitive wages are common due to high demand for skilled labor. In neighboring countries, average salaries may be lower—but across the board, financial stability is a key motivator. Performance-based incentives are appreciated and often drive engagement.

Promotions and job titles also carry significant weight—sometimes even more than monetary compensation. Keep that in mind when structuring compensation packages, and be aware of inflation and economic fluctuations, which can shift expectations quickly.

CONFLICT & COMMUNICATION STYLE

Across much of South Asia, communication leans formal and diplomatic—especially in writing. While emails are usually polished and deferential, live conversations (like video or voice calls) tend to feel more relaxed and allow for a bit more openness.

South Asian employees may avoid open disagreement or admitting uncertainty, opting instead for phrasing that preserves social harmony and protects their reputation.

Instead of a direct “no,” for instance, you might hear responses like “I’ll try” or “Inshallah.” These aren’t firm commitments—they’re polite ways to

express hesitation or uncertainty. But if you're not attuned to the nuance, it's easy to misinterpret them as agreement.

Direct confrontation is also typically avoided. Disagreements are handled with subtlety and framed in ways that show deference to authority and maintain group cohesion. To navigate this well, deliver constructive feedback privately and with care—public correction can feel shaming and erode trust.

On the flip side, public praise carries real weight—sometimes more than monetary rewards.

POWER & LEADERSHIP

Hierarchy is deeply embedded in South Asian workplaces. Seniority is respected, and decisions tend to be made top-down. Employees may be hesitant to challenge authority or take initiative without explicit permission.

That doesn't mean they're not capable—it just means the culture hasn't always rewarded risk-taking or innovation. Creating a safe environment for experimentation and mistake-making can unlock a lot of hidden potential.

FAMILY & PERSONAL LIFE

Family commitments are a top priority for South Asians. Weddings and other life events often require extended time off, and it's common for employees to take leave for religious or cultural holidays. India, for example, has more public holidays than almost any country in the world.

At the same time, many South Asian employees are accustomed to making up for missed work outside of standard hours and are well-versed in adapting to U.S. or European time zones.

REGIONAL RECAP: SOUTH ASIA

South Asia offers a high-potential, adaptable talent pool that responds best to clear expectations and structure. Indirect communication styles and a cultural reluctance to say “no” can lead to overcommitment, so frequent check-ins and transparency are key to long-term success.

LATIN AMERICA

Latin America is not a cultural monolith. Differences can be huge—from country to country, and even within countries. While there are common threads, it’s worth learning the nuances of wherever you’re hiring.

One key commonality however? Trust matters—deeply. It’s something that’s earned, not assumed, in both personal and professional relationships.

People here tend to be outgoing, vocal, and collaborative. There’s a strong entrepreneurial spirit, and a “work to live” mindset. Work ethic is high, but job titles rarely define identity.

Due to political and economic uncertainty in many parts of the region, Latin American professionals have developed strong adaptability—but beware: American employers sometimes mistake this resilience for disengagement or lack of motivation. It’s not.

And yes, punctuality can be a little fluid in some places—affectionately known as “Latin time.” But when the role requires strict punctuality, Latin American employees have no problem adapting to that expectation.

SALARY & INCENTIVE CONSIDERATIONS

Financial rewards are a big motivator in Latin America. Roles with commission structures, quotas, and performance-based bonuses tend to land well. But here’s a unique twist—sometimes, when employees hit a

financial goal that covers their needs for a while, they just... peace out. They're not quitting in frustration—they're just "good."

To prevent this, it's smart to stretch bonuses and incentives out over time instead of offering big lump sums upfront.

Flexibility also ranks high on the list of motivators—sometimes even higher than salary. Many Latin American professionals value work-life balance as much as financial compensation.

And a quick country-specific note: In Argentina (and possibly other parts of South America), employees receive a "13th salary," known as Aguinaldo. It's split into two payments—one in July and one in December—and is considered a standard part of compensation.

CONFLICT & COMMUNICATION STYLE

Latin Americans are known for being warm, passionate, and expressive. In places like Mexico and Brazil, that passion can be intense—which might feel overwhelming to folks with softer communication styles.

However, conflict styles vary. Argentinians, for example, tend to be exceedingly polite and approach sensitive topics with nuance and care. Others in the region may lean more direct, preferring straight talk without too much sugar coating.

Communication styles also run the gamut in Latin America. Argentinians, again, are typically more formal and polite, while other cultures in the region may prefer a more casual, candid tone. But across the board, you'll find warmth and personal connection are woven into every interaction.

Because of that, corporate jargon and overly rigid systems can come across as impersonal or overly formal to these employees.

That same need for authentic connection can also make remote work feel a bit isolating. To bridge the gap, consider creating Slack channels for shared interests, holding regular team huddles, and making space for fun, low-stakes moments that help people feel like part of a community.

POWER & LEADERSHIP

Hierarchy in Latin America is generally more relaxed—similar to what you might see in the U.S. Employees are often comfortable interacting with leadership and may feel empowered to contribute ideas, especially in flatter organizational structures.

Team loyalty and group cohesion matter. Team projects and shared goals tend to boost morale and engagement.

FAMILY & PERSONAL LIFE

Family is central to Latin culture. There are plenty of holidays, religious festivals, and social obligations that occasionally take precedence over work—and unlike in India, Latin American employees aren't always inclined to make up missed hours.

Personal time is guarded a little more fiercely here. Latin American professionals often have rich personal lives filled with hobbies, social gatherings, and activities outside of work. Respecting that boundary is key to long-term retention.

REGIONAL RECAP: LATIN AMERICA

Latin America brings energy, loyalty, and strong cultural alignment with U.S.-based teams. Communication styles feel familiar, time zones are convenient, and relationships matter. A warm, trust-based approach will go much further than rigid processes or formality.

While you may need to dig a bit deeper for certain technical skills compared to Asia, the ease of collaboration and high engagement more than make up for it—making Latin America an excellent region to hire from.

EASTERN EUROPE

Eastern Europeans are resilient, skilled, and incredibly proud of their work. Decades of political and economic upheaval—and a famously unforgiving climate—have forged a workforce that’s tough, pragmatic, and deeply committed to excellence.

They take deadlines and deliverables seriously. If they commit, they’ll deliver. If they’re not sure they can, they won’t say yes.

However, when you pair them with teams from regions where timelines are more flexible (like South Asia), expect some friction—unless you bridge those cultural expectations upfront.

SALARY & INCENTIVE CONSIDERATIONS

Eastern Europe offers a skilled, efficient workforce—but if you’re hoping for deep financial arbitrage, this isn’t the region. Wages are higher than in some other parts of the world, but the value is still there, especially when you factor in the quality of work.

Job security is a major motivator. Flexibility is nice, but stability is what really wins loyalty here. Once Eastern European employees feel secure, they commit hard and take real ownership of their work.

They’re problem solvers, but rule-followers too. Unlike some regions where workarounds are embraced, Eastern Europeans tend to follow the process. They value fairness, own their mistakes, and expect the same from everyone else.

CONFLICT & COMMUNICATION STYLE

Eastern Europeans are famously direct. They're not easily offended, and they don't dance around an issue. They appreciate straightforward communication—and they expect the same in return.

This directness applies to leadership, too. They won't blindly follow orders; they want to understand the reasoning behind a decision. If something doesn't make sense, they'll ask why. But once they respect you, they'll follow you—and with serious buy-in.

If you earn their trust and respect, you'll see initiative and innovation. But if they sense incompetence, they'll quietly disengage. No drama—just distance.

Communication is no-nonsense. At first, employees may come off as formal or reserved—but give it time, and you'll start to see humor (often of the dark, dry variety) and warmth emerge.

They appreciate praise—but only if it's real. Over-the-top flattery or vague recognition will fall flat or feel fake. Keep your compliments specific and to the point.

The same goes for feedback. Constructive criticism is welcomed—but it better be clear, backed by examples, and actionable. Vague or wishy-washy feedback will be challenged, not absorbed.

Idealistic vision statements and lofty goals may be met with skepticism. Practicality wins the day here.

POWER & LEADERSHIP

Hierarchy exists, but it's conditional. Respect must be earned. Eastern Europeans will follow strong, competent leaders—but age, title, or job description alone won't cut it.

They're far less likely to take direction from someone who appears inexperienced, insecure, or unsure of themselves.

Trust is everything. Once they feel safe and valued, you'll get fierce loyalty. But they don't suffer fools—and if someone isn't pulling their weight, they won't make a scene... they'll just mentally check out.

FAMILY & PERSONAL LIFE

In Eastern Europe, family plays a big role in motivation and decision-making. Cultural values around duty, obligation, and sacrifice run deep. Employees are often working for more than just themselves—and they bring that same seriousness into their roles.

While they do appreciate vacation time, they may not feel compelled to take time off for birthdays or cultural celebrations unless encouraged to do so.

REGIONAL RECAP: EASTERN EUROPE

Eastern European employees are pragmatic, direct, and deeply committed to high standards. Lead with competence, communicate clearly, and back up feedback with specifics. Once you earn their respect, they'll give you loyalty and execution you can count on.

NORTH AFRICA & THE MIDDLE EAST

Employees in North Africa and the Middle East are incredibly resilient. They excel under pressure, and they know how to rally in tough situations. In times of crisis, a strong sense of community and cooperation kicks in. They band together to solve problems—fast.

Time and punctuality can vary. In some cases, deadlines are treated with flexibility unless a clear sense of urgency is established. Relationships and

harmony may take precedence over rigid timelines, so it's essential to set expectations early and reinforce them regularly.

SALARY & INCENTIVE CONSIDERATIONS

In North Africa and the Middle East, money talks. Financial stability is a major motivator—largely because many employees contribute significantly to their extended family's well-being. Bonuses, raises, and performance-based incentives are highly valued and deeply appreciated.

Public recognition also holds weight—if it's delivered authentically and from someone they respect. It's not about showboating; it's about acknowledgment that feels real and earned.

Job security is also a major driver. Employees want to feel confident that they're in a stable role where their efforts are both seen and rewarded.

CONFLICT & COMMUNICATION STYLE

Communication in this region is colorful—full of metaphor, hyperbole, and emotion. Reading between the lines is essential, because the literal meaning of words isn't always the full story. There's an art to the way things are said.

Negotiation is a skill, and employees here tend to be excellent at it. They're comfortable with back-and-forth, and they can handle objections without taking offense—which makes them great fits for sales and client-facing roles.

That strength, though, can sometimes be a double-edged sword. In their eagerness to win someone over, employees may overpromise or come on too strong. Setting clear boundaries and building in checks and balances helps keep things grounded.

Feedback must be handled with care. Saving face is a strong cultural value, so even kind, constructive feedback can feel personal if not delivered tactfully. Always give feedback privately with your North African and Middle East employees—and with clear affirmation that the person is valued.

Early on, you may see “cover your ass” behaviors—over-documentation, defensiveness, or excessive clarification. It’s not lack of confidence; it’s self-preservation. Once trust is built, that behavior fades—and you’ll often see creativity and initiative flourish.

While the region tends to lean toward stability over experimentation (understandable, given historical challenges), when employees feel protected and supported, they’ll begin to take more risks and show greater initiative.

POWER & LEADERSHIP

In this part of the world, relationships run the show. Business is deeply personal, and trust is everything—often more important than whatever’s written in the contract.

Employees from North Africa and the Middle East may hesitate to take initiative right away. They want to understand expectations, build trust with leadership, and feel confident that they won’t be penalized for stepping out of line.

Leaders are often seen as protectors—someone who shields the team from chaos, not someone who delegates and disappears.

Passion and strong opinions are common—and welcome. Once trust is in place, those qualities fuel some seriously outstanding work.

FAMILY LIFE

Family isn't just important in this region—it's everything. The definition of "family" often stretches to include third and fourth cousins, and those obligations can easily blur the line between work and personal life.

Which means employees may take personal calls during work or step away unexpectedly for family matters. But they're also likely to respond to urgent work needs while attending family events. The balance swings both ways, and dedication runs deep.

This sense of familial duty shapes how employees approach time, availability, and responsibility. They're not compartmentalizing work and life—they're integrating the two.

REGIONAL RECAP: NORTH AFRICA & THE MIDDLE EAST

Trust and relationships are everything in this region. Lead with empathy, communicate clearly, and handle feedback with care. Family and personal connection often come first—so align your expectations and leadership style with those values. Once trust is established, you'll see loyalty, creativity, and a deep sense of dedication.

BONUS: CANADA

Most people don't think of Canada when they think about "outsourcing"—but they should! When cultural differences and language barriers become real hurdles, Canada can be one of the best places to find quality talent and still benefit from the financial arbitrage of a stronger dollar.

The cold weather plays a surprising role in Canada's strong work ethic. In many regions, long winters mean people spend more time

indoors—resulting in a culture that prizes focus, productivity, and consistency. Canadians are known for being hard-working, diligent, and steady—especially in colder provinces where seasonal distractions are limited.

Canada is a particularly smart choice for client-facing roles. You get strong cultural alignment with U.S.-based customers—minus the premium price tag or the cultural friction that can come with outsourcing to more distant regions.

SALARY & INCENTIVE CONSIDERATIONS

Canada is a smart option for cost-effective hiring—especially if you're U.S.-based. Thanks to a favorable exchange rate, paying \$50K USD translates to about \$70K CAD. That means you can hire high-performing senior talent at a discount compared to U.S. rates.

But keep in mind, Canada's a big place, and salary expectations vary by region. Cities like Toronto and Vancouver come with higher costs of living, often comparable to major U.S. metros. But in mid-sized cities like Edmonton or Calgary, you'll find the sweet spot: top-tier talent at a more affordable rate.

An added bonus? Canada's universal health coverage means one less layer of complexity compared to hiring in the U.S.

CONFLICT & COMMUNICATION STYLE

Culturally, Canadians and Americans are very similar—but there are a few key distinctions. Canadians tend to be more reserved and famously polite (yes, they really do say “sorry” a lot). This politeness can sometimes come across as indirectness, especially when it comes to conflict.

Canadians often avoid confrontation and prefer to address issues diplomatically, making them easy to work with in team settings.

POWER & LEADERSHIP

Canadian workplaces generally value structure and stability. While hierarchy exists, it tends to be less rigid than in some other cultures. Managers are approachable, and teams often lean toward consensus-based decision-making rather than top-down commands.

That said, Canada leans slightly more bureaucratic than the U.S., especially in government-adjacent sectors. This can sometimes dampen entrepreneurial ambition—but that’s actually a plus if you’re hiring. Many Canadians who might start a business in the U.S. choose secure, long-term employment instead.

As a result, you’ll find a labor pool full of highly skilled professionals who value clarity, consistency, and well-run organizations.

FAMILY & PERSONAL LIFE

In Canada, work-life balance is baked into the culture. Evenings, weekends, and family time are generally respected, and most employers don’t expect you to be “always on.” That doesn’t mean Canadians are any less committed. If anything, their strong focus on family tends to show up as consistency, reliability, and long-term loyalty.

Many Canadians are raising families in stable, mid-sized cities with great schools, safe neighborhoods, and plenty of green space. It’s the kind of lifestyle that supports focused work, low turnover, and people who show up—not just today, but for the long haul.

REGIONAL RECAP: CANADA

Canada offers a rare combination: cultural alignment with the U.S., a favorable exchange rate, and a highly skilled, reliable workforce. If you want top-tier talent that understands the U.S. market, integrates seamlessly with your team, and avoids the complexity of major time zone or language differences—Canada is a no-brainer.

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION

Dutch social psychologist Geert Hofstede developed a framework called *The Five Dimensions of Culture*, designed to help people understand cultural differences across countries. If you're looking to dive deeper into a specific region, it's a great place to start.

You can learn more about Hofstede's work at theculturefactor.com

TEMPLATES AND RESOURCES

Scan the QR code to access everything in one place! This includes templates such as a Job Posting, Trial Project Offer, Trial Project Details, Rejection Letter, Schedule Email, and Contractor Agreement, along with valuable resources like a Global Job Board, a One-Page Cheat Sheet, and a Comprehensive Workbook to support your hiring process.

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